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What's *actually* in the bills.

A non-partisan, plain-language citizen's packet on the major bills before Canada's federal Parliament and all ten provincial legislatures — with strengths, weaknesses, and privacy & civil-liberties implications.

125 bills · Federal (45th Parliament, 1st session) + 10 provinces · Updated June 17, 2026

Informational and non-partisan; not legal advice. Bill statuses change quickly — always confirm on the official sources (LEGISinfo for federal; each province's legislature site). Compiled from official parliamentary/legislature records and reputable legal and civil-liberties analysis.

45th Parliament, 1st session

Government: Liberal majority under Prime Minister Mark Carney. The headline civil-liberties bills are C-2/C-12/C-22 (borders & surveillance), C-8 (cyber), C-9 (hate), C-14 (bail), and C-34 (social media).

C-22 Lawful Access Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Public Safety Minister Gary Anandasangaree · Status: In committee (SECU) — passed 2nd reading Apr 20; being rushed before summer

The surveillance powers carved out of the border bill (C-2). Lets police and CSIS demand "subscriber information" (name, address, account and device IDs) on a low "reasonable suspicion" threshold without a warrant; adds "confirmation of service" demands with gag orders; metadata retention; and pressures providers to build access capabilities.

FOR

Police say the law predates modern apps and slows serious investigations.

AGAINST

The CCLA and Citizen Lab catalogued its flaws; the Privacy Commissioner, Michael Geist and Fasken call it the central privacy concern of the session. Apple warned it would force companies to break encryption by inserting backdoors.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Everyone with a phone or internet account; encrypted-service users; journalists and their sources.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

The country's highest-stakes privacy fight: warrantless/low-threshold data access, gag orders, encryption backdoors, and U.S. cross-border data demands (CLOUD Act).

C-2 Strong Borders Act (omnibus origin) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Public Safety Minister Gary Anandasangaree · Status: Stalled at 2nd reading — split into C-12 (law) + C-22

The original 127-page omnibus on border security, immigration/asylum, anti-money-laundering and sweeping new police/CSIS data powers. After a backlash it was split: immigration/border → C-12 (now law); surveillance → C-22 (in committee).

FOR

Targets fentanyl, gun smuggling and organized crime; responds to U.S. border pressure. Splitting the bill was itself a partial concession.

AGAINST

300+ organizations demanded full withdrawal. The government's own Charter Statement flags Section 8 (search/seizure) risks: a lowered warrant standard, warrantless inquiries to banks, hotels, car rentals, doctors and telecoms, and CSIS queries about non-citizens "on no grounds at all." Lawyers call a constitutional challenge inevitable.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Everyone online, mail senders, immigrants and asylum seekers, journalists.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Origin of the surveillance fight — its live concerns now flow through C-12 (enacted) and C-22 (in committee).

C-12 Strengthening Canada's Immigration System and Borders Act HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Public Safety Minister Gary Anandasangaree · Status: Law — Royal Assent March 26, 2026

The border/immigration half of C-2, now law. Sets new asylum time limits — people in Canada more than a year are barred from a refugee hearing — lets the government pause, cancel or change immigration applications and documents "in the public interest," expands data-sharing, and gives Canada Post authority to open mail in some cases.

FOR

Faster removals, asylum-system integrity, and alignment with U.S. border demands.

AGAINST

The one-year bar can trap genuine refugees; broad ministerial discretion; the Canadian Council for Refugees opposed it.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Immigrants, refugees, and anyone who receives mail.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Cross-agency/government data-sharing, mail-opening powers, and reduced asylum due process.

C-8 Cyber Security Act (Telecom Act + Critical Cyber Systems Protection Act) WATCH

Sponsor: Public Safety Minister Gary Anandasangaree · Status: Law — Royal Assent June 15, 2026 (S.C. 2026, c.9)

Lets Cabinet and the Industry Minister order telecoms to secure their systems and drop specified vendors, and creates the Critical Cyber Systems Protection Act for finance, telecom, energy, nuclear and transportation (mandatory protections, incident reports, binding directions).

FOR

Real protection for hospitals, banks, grids and pipelines against ransomware and state-backed cyberattacks; aligns Canada with allies.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Secrecy/gag provisions mean a company could be ordered to act with no public transparency; security power concentrated in Cabinet.

AGAINST

Sweeping powers with thin independent oversight: orders can be secret and even forbid disclosing that they exist; heavy compliance costs.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Telecom/internet customers and operators of critical infrastructure — ultimately everyone.

C-9 Combatting Hate Act WATCH

Sponsor: Justice Minister Sean Fraser · Status: Passed House & Senate (amended June 4) — awaiting final concurrence + Royal Assent

Amends the Criminal Code on hate propaganda and hate crime, creates offences for obstructing access to places of worship, schools and community centres, and toughens penalties for hate-motivated crime.

FOR

Responds to a documented rise in hate incidents and protects people's ability to worship and gather safely; welcomed by many faith and community groups.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

The fight here is free expression and freedom of assembly, not data privacy — outcome depends heavily on how police and courts apply it.

AGAINST

The CCLA, Canadian Constitution Foundation, Canadian Labour Congress and several religious groups warn the wording is broad and could chill free expression, good-faith religious teaching, and peaceful protest or picket lines.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Minority and faith communities (intended protection); protesters, clergy and online commentators (expression risk).

C-14 Bail and Sentencing Reform Act WATCH

Sponsor: Justice Minister · Status: Law — Royal Assent June 15, 2026 (S.C. 2026, c.11)

Makes bail harder via expanded "reverse onus" (the accused must justify release) for repeat/violent crime, auto theft, home invasion, organized crime and infrastructure offences; allows consecutive sentences; and ends house arrest for sexual assault.

FOR

Responds to strong public concern about repeat violent offenders and car theft; targets organized crime; victims' advocates back the sexual-assault change.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Due process, the presumption of innocence, and equality rights.

AGAINST

The CCLA and Canadian Bar Association warn of Charter Section 7 violations — "no evidence bail causes crime" — more pre-trial jailing of legally-innocent people, and disproportionate impact on Indigenous, Black and racialized people.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone charged before trial; marginalized communities most acutely; crime victims (intended benefit).

C-34 Safe Social Media Act (enacts the Digital Safety Act) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Minister of Canadian Heritage · Status: In progress (introduced ~June 2026)

Would ban under-16s from social media; require platforms to use age verification/estimation (ID upload or AI face-scan); create a Digital Safety Commission (fines up to 3% of global revenue); and add AI-chatbot rules. Verification data is supposed to be discarded after the check.

FOR

Targets youth mental health and online harms, with a regulator that has real teeth.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Age verification becomes identity verification for everyone; biometric/face-scan risks; chills anonymous speech (whistleblowers, abuse survivors, dissidents).

AGAINST

The CCLA and Michael Geist warn that keeping kids out means every adult must verify too — effectively mandating ID or face-scans to use the internet — and the verification infrastructure is permanent even if the ban is "temporary."

WHO IT AFFECTS

Every social-media user, teens under 16, and platforms.

C-36 Protecting Privacy and Consumer Data Act (PIPEDA reform) WATCH

Sponsor: Minister of AI & Digital Innovation, Evan Solomon · Status: First reading June 15, 2026 — earliest stage

Replaces Part 1 of PIPEDA (Canada's private-sector privacy law). Adds consent rules, rights to access and delete your data, breach-notification duties, mandatory privacy officers, and rules for AI "automated decision systems" — including an explanation when AI makes a significant decision about you — plus a new compliance commission.

FOR

A long-overdue modernization of consumer privacy with new AI transparency.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Could either strengthen or weaken your data rights — the fine print and final amendments decide.

AGAINST

The CCLA says it actually erodes federal privacy rights and fails to meaningfully address well-documented AI harms; the strength of the rights depends on enforcement teeth and "legitimate business interest" exceptions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Every consumer, and every business that handles personal data.

C-25 Strong and Free Elections Act WATCH

Sponsor: Minister of Democratic Institutions · Status: In Senate committee

Targets foreign interference and deepfakes: extends interference offences to between elections, bans foreign influence on nominations and leadership races, bans crypto/money-order/prepaid donations, tightens third-party foreign funding, and curbs "long-ballot" protests.

FOR

Modernizes election-integrity defences and closes real loopholes.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Political-party data rules and voter data.

AGAINST

Watch effects on legitimate third-party advocacy and free political expression, plus how political parties handle voter data.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Voters, parties, and advocacy groups.

C-29 Financial Crimes Agency Act WATCH

Sponsor: Government bill · Status: Second reading

Creates a new standalone federal financial-crime police agency (money laundering, fraud, sanctions evasion, crypto laundering, cyber-enabled crime) with investigative, policing and asset-recovery powers, wired into the Privacy Act, Criminal Code, immigration and sanctions laws.

FOR

Canada has been criticized as weak on money laundering ("snow-washing"); a dedicated agency could finally deliver enforcement.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Broad data access across financial and personal records.

AGAINST

A powerful new body plugged into financial and personal data — oversight and accountability are the open questions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

The financial sector, suspects, and ordinary account-holders indirectly.

C-5 One Canadian Economy Act WATCH

Sponsor: Dominic LeBlanc · Status: Law — Royal Assent June 26, 2025 (S.C. 2025, c.2)

Enacts the Free Trade and Labour Mobility in Canada Act and the Building Canada Act — removes interprovincial trade/labour barriers and lets Cabinet fast-track "national-interest" projects, partly bypassing normal review timelines.

FOR

Could boost growth and get pipelines, transmission and housing built faster; a response to the U.S. trade war.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data privacy; the civil-liberties concern is Indigenous rights (duty to consult, UNDRIP) and environmental protection.

AGAINST

First Nations (incl. Chiefs of Ontario) and environmental groups warn it bypasses meaningful Indigenous consultation and environmental review, with broad Cabinet discretion.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Indigenous communities, the environment, industry and workers.

C-4 Making Life More Affordable for Canadians Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Finance Minister · Status: Law — Royal Assent March 12, 2026

Cuts the lowest income-tax rate from 15% to 14%, eliminates GST for first-time buyers on new homes up to \$1M (reduced up to \$1.5M), repeals the consumer carbon price, and changes political parties' personal-information rules.

FOR

Direct cost-of-living relief; the carbon-price repeal was widely popular.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Nationalizes (modest) privacy rules for political parties.

AGAINST

Repeal removes a climate tool and the rebate many lower-income households received; the home-buyer break may partly inflate prices.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Taxpayers, first-time home buyers, and lower-income households.

C-3 Citizenship Act amendment ('Lost Canadians') RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Immigration Minister · Status: Law — Royal Assent Nov 20, 2025 (S.C. 2025, c.5)

Restores citizenship-by-descent rights that courts had struck down, fixing the "Lost Canadians" problem.

FOR

Corrects a rights violation and helps affected families.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Limited opposition.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Canadians born abroad and their children.

C-19 Canada Groceries and Essentials Benefit RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Finance Minister · Status: Law — Royal Assent Feb 12, 2026

Creates a new income-tested benefit to help with the cost of food and essentials.

FOR

Targeted cost-of-living relief.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Debate over whether the scope and amount are adequate.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Lower-income households.

C-16 Protecting Victims Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Justice Minister · Status: In committee

Improves disclosure to victims and the submission of victim statements in the corrections/parole process, with child-protection and gender-based-violence measures.

FOR

Strengthens victims' rights in the justice system.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Handling of victim information.

AGAINST

Limited.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Crime victims.

C-20 Build Canada Homes RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Government bill · Status: In committee

Stands up a federal housing agency to boost supply, part of the government's housing push.

FOR

Aimed squarely at the housing-affordability crisis.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Questions about execution, cost and how fast it delivers.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Renters and would-be buyers.

C-37 First Nations Clean Water RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Indigenous Services · Status: In progress

Creates an enforceable safe-drinking-water framework for First Nations.

FOR

An overdue fix for a long-standing rights and public-health failure.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Questions about funding adequacy and enforcement.

WHO IT AFFECTS

First Nations communities.

Nova Scotia House of Assembly

Session: 65th General Assembly, 1st Session (since Dec 2024)

Government: Progressive Conservative majority (42 of 55 seats) under Premier Tim Houston

A fast-moving, high-majority session. The fall 2025 sitting pushed several bills through in days; the spring 2026 sitting ran a record 27 days, passed the budget amid protests over grant cuts, and at one point barred the public from Province House.

Bill 150 Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Attorney General / Justice Minister Becky Druhan (PC) · Status: Law — Royal Assent Oct 3, 2025 (in force April 1, 2027)

The first rewrite of Nova Scotia's freedom-of-information and privacy law in 25 years — rushed through in about a week, bypassing meaningful committee scrutiny.

FOR

Makes the Privacy Commissioner an independent officer of the legislature; modernizes a decades-old statute.

AGAINST

The commissioner still cannot issue binding orders (only recommendations); a broad new 'Executive Council records' category walls off cabinet records far beyond traditional confidences; the Centre for Law and Democracy and privacy experts decried the one-week, no-real-hearings process.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

This IS the province's core access-to-information and privacy law — more commissioner independence, but weaker public access and a still-toothless watchdog.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone who files a freedom-of-information request, journalists, and the public's right to know.

Bill 1 Government Organization and Administration Act (omnibus) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law (auditor-general clauses withdrawn)

An omnibus bill that originally gave Cabinet the power to fire the Auditor General without cause and to refuse 'frivolous or vexatious' freedom-of-information requests.

FOR

Pitched as government 'efficiency' and curbing a handful of very high-volume requesters.

AGAINST

The auditor-general firing power triggered province-wide outrage and was withdrawn; critics called it a raw attack on independent oversight and transparency.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Democratic accountability and the public's right to know — watchdog independence and FOI access.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Oversight bodies and every citizen who relies on government transparency.

Bill 6 Agriculture, Energy and Natural Resources Act WATCH

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law — effective March 26, 2025

Lifts the 40-plus-year ban on uranium exploration/mining and the 2014 ban on onshore fracking, pitched as resource self-reliance amid U.S. tariffs.

FOR

Potential resource revenue, jobs and energy security; allows research into uranium deposits.

AGAINST

99 public submissions against, 1 in favour; strong opposition from Mi'kmaq communities, environmental groups and rural residents over water, health and Indigenous rights.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data-privacy angle; the civil-liberties concern is Indigenous consent (duty to consult) and environmental protection.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Rural and Mi'kmaq communities, the environment, the resource sector.

Bill 130 Traffic Safety Act WATCH

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law — Royal Assent Oct 3, 2025 (takes effect 2026)

Replaces the 1930s-era Motor Vehicle Act and, for the first time in Nova Scotia, authorizes photo radar, red-light cameras and intersection cameras.

FOR

Overdue modernization; automated enforcement can cut speeding and collisions at dangerous spots.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

New automated camera surveillance of drivers — the privacy details live in the 2026 regulations to come.

AGAINST

Automated cameras mean routine surveillance of drivers — concerns about data retention, who sees footage, function creep and revenue-driven enforcement.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Every driver in Nova Scotia.

Bill 205 Elections Act & House of Assembly Act (amended) WATCH

Sponsor: Attorney General / Justice Minister Scott Armstrong (PC) · Status: Law — Royal Assent April 9, 2026

Modernizes elections on the Chief Electoral Officer's recommendations: limited electronic voting, removal of the returning-officer residency rule and the \$200 nomination deposit — and it expands who may use the voter roll.

FOR

Streamlines elections, widens voting access, and most changes were expert-recommended after the 2021/2024 elections.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

The province's #2 privacy issue after Bill 150 — more people (parties, candidates, MLAs) can use your voter data for more purposes (incl. fundraising).

AGAINST

It broadens permitted uses of the Register of Electors (voter roll) to include soliciting contributions, campaigning and recruiting party members — a real voter-data privacy expansion; e-voting raises security questions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Every registered voter.

Bill 127 Protecting Nova Scotians Act (omnibus) WATCH

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law — Royal Assent Oct 3, 2025

A controversial omnibus bill that amends the Crown Lands Act (among other statutes), passed quickly during the fall 2025 sitting.

FOR

Framed by the government as streamlining and protecting Nova Scotians.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Limited/uncertain direct privacy angle; the concern is rushed omnibus law-making and Crown-land/resource governance.

AGAINST

Criticized by CBC, the Halifax Examiner and others as a rushed omnibus with resource and rights implications; specific provisions drew pushback.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Crown-land users and, broadly, the public.

Bill 198 Financial Measures (2026) Act WATCH

Sponsor: Finance Minister John Lohr (PC) · Status: Law

Enacts Budget 2026-27 and creates a recurring vehicle levy effective Oct 1, 2026: \$500 every two years on electric vehicles and \$250 on hybrids.

FOR

Pitched as road-funding fairness as gas-tax revenue falls; Nova Scotia would be the 4th province to do it.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal — this is a tax/fiscal measure.

AGAINST

Penalizes cleaner vehicles, adds an affordability hit, and may discourage EV adoption.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Electric-vehicle and hybrid owners.

Bill 193 Powering the Economy Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law — April 9, 2026

Secures offshore-wind revenue (a levy of \$7,000/MW for the first 10 years), shifts grid responsibilities from Nova Scotia Power to a new IESO Nova Scotia, and creates a Subsurface Energy Resource Extraction Act covering geothermal, natural hydrogen, helium and carbon storage.

FOR

Energy modernization, new revenue, and grid-governance reform after Nova Scotia Power's troubles (including a major data breach).

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Ratepayer-impact and pace-of-change questions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Nova Scotia Power ratepayers and the energy sector.

Bill 11 Administrative Efficiency and Accountability in Healthcare Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: PC government · Status: Law

Restructures health-system administration as part of the government's health-care overhaul.

FOR

Aims to cut red tape and improve accountability in a strained system.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Watch health-data handling as systems are consolidated.

AGAINST

Critics question centralization and whether it improves front-line care.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Patients and health-care workers.

Bill 249 Distribution of Fake Intimate Images Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Suzy Hansen (NDP) — private member's bill · Status: Private member's bill (before the House)

Would amend the Intimate Images and Cyber-protection Act to cover AI-generated and deepfake intimate images.

FOR

Closes a real gap as deepfake abuse rises; protects victims.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Rights-positive — strengthens protection against non-consensual and AI-faked intimate images.

AGAINST

As a private member's bill it is less likely to advance without government support.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Victims of image-based and deepfake abuse.

Bill 131 Privacy and Credit Protection Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Susan Leblanc (NDP) — private member's bill · Status: Private member's bill (before the House)

Would add consumer data-privacy and credit-protection rights.

FOR

Stronger consumer privacy and protection against credit/identity harms.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Rights-positive consumer-privacy proposal.

AGAINST

Private member's bills rarely advance under a majority government.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Consumers and anyone exposed to data/credit misuse.

Bill 140 Private Data Protection Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Derek Mombourquette (Liberal) — private member's bill · Status: Private member's bill (before the House)

Would create personal-data protection rights in the private sector provincially.

FOR

Fills gaps in provincial private-sector privacy coverage.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Rights-positive private-sector privacy proposal.

AGAINST

Unlikely to advance without government backing.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone whose data is held by NS businesses.

Legislative Assembly of Ontario (Queen's Park)

Session: 44th Parliament, 1st Session. Opened April 14, 2025 following the February 27, 2025 general election; still sitting as of June 2026. Speaker: Donna Skelly (PC).

Government: Progressive Conservative (PC) majority. Premier Doug Ford. The PCs won a third consecutive majority on Feb 27, 2025, taking about 80 of 124 seats (63 needed for a majority). Official Opposition: NDP (Marit Stiles), ~27 seats; Liberals ~14; Greens 2.

Context: This is the first session after Doug Ford's PCs won a rare third straight majority on Feb 27, 2025 in a snap winter election fought over U.S. tariffs; the session has been dominated by 'Protect Ontario'-branded omnibus bills on the economy, development, public safety and budget measures, and by aggressive centralization of power (over municipalities, school boards and information access). The single most consequential and contested law is Bill 5 (special economic zones / Endangered Species Act repeal), now before the courts in a constitutional challenge by 14+ First Nations. The clearest civil-liberties/privacy flashpoints are Bill 5 (rule of law, Indigenous rights), Bill 6 (criminalizing homelessness + notwithstanding-clause threat), Bill 97 (gutting FOI/transparency, criticized by the Information and Privacy Commissioner), Bill 119 (public offender-naming website, still in committee), and Bill 33 (police in schools). Important status caveats: (1) Bill 119 is alive in the Standing Committee on Justice Policy after a June 2, 2026 closure motion - some secondary sources wrongly reported it 'lost'; (2) Bill 105 (POWER Act) is still in the legislative process, not yet law. Many other bills exist - a large number are opposition private member's bills (most defeated on division by the PC majority, e.g. rent stabilization, anti-scab labour, fair-elections and accountability bills) and numerous trivial commemorative-day bills, which were deliberately excluded. Two Ontario private member's bills on youth online safety (Bill 137 Keeping Our Kids Safe Online, Bill 138 Social Media Age Restriction Plan) sit at first reading but are minor relative to the parallel federal Bill C-34. All statuses were checked on ola.org and corroborating sources as of June 17, 2026; bills can change quickly.

Bill 5 Protect Ontario by Unleashing our Economy Act, 2025 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Stephen Lecce, Minister of Energy and Mines (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received June 2025; Statutes of Ontario 2025, c. 4. Subject of an ongoing constitutional challenge by 14+ First Nations in the Ontario Superior Court (injunction sought against designating special economic zones).

Omnibus development-acceleration law. Its centrepiece, the new Special Economic Zones Act, 2025, lets Cabinet designate geographic 'special economic zones' and name 'trusted proponents' who can be exempted by regulation from any provincial law, regulation or municipal bylaw the government chooses. It also repeals the Endangered Species Act and replaces it with a weaker Species Conservation Act, 2025, streamlines the Mining Act, and cancels/exempts specific environmental assessments (Eagle's Nest mine, Rebuilding Ontario Place, a Chatham-Kent waste site). The Ring of Fire mining region is the intended first zone.

FOR

Government and industry argue it cuts permitting delays, speeds up critical-minerals and energy projects, attracts investment, and is a response to U.S. tariffs and economic uncertainty. Supporters frame it as jobs and economic sovereignty for Northern Ontario.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Privacy implications are indirect but real: because designation lets Cabinet exempt projects from 'any' provincial law, it could in principle override provincial environmental-disclosure, archaeological, and transparency requirements within a zone. The deeper civil-liberties concern is rule-of-law and Charter (s. 35 Indigenous rights; s. 7 life, liberty, security) rather than data privacy specifically.

AGAINST

Widely condemned by First Nations (Chiefs of Ontario, Association of Iroquois and Allied Indians), legal scholars, and groups including the CCLA, Environmental Defence, Ontario Nature and Amnesty International. Critics say handing Cabinet power to suspend any law for chosen companies guts the rule of law, the duty to consult Indigenous peoples, environmental safeguards and democratic oversight, and creates corruption/favouritism risk. Passed with no Indigenous consultation despite large protests.

WHO IT AFFECTS

First Nations whose territories overlap designated zones (especially the Ring of Fire); Northern Ontario communities; mining/energy companies; environmental and heritage protections; anyone relying on consistent application of provincial law.

Bill 6 Safer Municipalities Act, 2025 (encampments / public drug use / trespass) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Solicitor General's portfolio (Hon. Michael Kerzner), government bill · Status: Royal Assent / law - received June 5, 2025.

Aimed at clearing homeless encampments. It enacts the Restricting Public Consumption of Illegal Substances Act, prohibiting use of illegal drugs in public places (including tents in parks), with fines up to \$10,000 or up to 6 months' jail. It amends the Trespass to Property Act to add aggravating sentencing factors (e.g. re-entering premises) and strengthens enforcement against repeat trespass, with arrest powers and an option to divert people to court. Paired with ~\$75.5M for homelessness prevention.

FOR

Backed by ~16 municipal mayors and the government as a tool to restore safety in parks and public spaces and to give police/municipalities clear authority. Includes some funding for 'reasonable alternative accommodation' and diversion options.

AGAINST

Human-rights advocates, the Canadian Mental Health Association, Amnesty International and legal experts say it criminalizes poverty, addiction and homelessness without solving the housing shortage, and may push vulnerable people into the justice system or out of sight. Concern was amplified because Ford publicly threatened to invoke the Charter's notwithstanding clause (s. 33) to override courts if they struck the law down.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Direct privacy/civil-liberties concern is the expanded police power to stop, ticket and arrest people in public space and the chilling threat to pre-emptively use the notwithstanding clause to shield the law from Charter review (s. 7, s. 9 arbitrary detention, s. 12). Data-privacy impact is modest; the core issue is policing of marginalized people.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People experiencing homelessness and those who use drugs; encampment residents; municipalities and police; harm-reduction and outreach workers; downstream, taxpayers and the courts.

Bill 97 Plan to Protect Ontario Act (Budget Measures), 2026 - including FIPPA secrecy changes HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Peter Bethlenfalvy, Minister of Finance (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received April 24, 2026.

The 2026 budget-implementation omnibus. Beyond fiscal measures, it amended the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FIPPA) to shield from public access certain records of the Premier, Cabinet ministers, parliamentary assistants and their staff offices - applied retroactively - and roughly doubled the time ministries/agencies have to answer FOI requests.

FOR

Government frames the FOI changes as protecting candid political/policy advice and reducing administrative burden, and the budget measures as protecting Ontario's economy amid U.S. tariffs.

AGAINST

Ontario's Information and Privacy Commissioner, Patricia Kosseim, was a vocal critic, calling it among the most restrictive changes in FIPPA's ~40-year history, warning it 'eviscerates' public accountability and that retroactivity sends the message 'if oversight bodies get in the way, just change the rules.' Journalists and transparency advocates say it makes Ontario less transparent than even the federal government and hides how high-level decisions are made.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Squarely a transparency/access-to-information issue (the public's right to know), which is the flip side of the Privacy Commissioner's mandate. It reduces citizens' ability to obtain records about government decision-making; doubling response times further weakens timely access. High civil-liberties/accountability concern.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Journalists, researchers, opposition parties, advocacy groups and any citizen using FOI; the Information and Privacy Commissioner; broadly, democratic accountability in Ontario.

Bill 119 Protecting Ontario's Streets and Communities Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Michael S. Kerzner, Solicitor General (PC) · Status: In committee - introduced (first reading) May 25, 2026; passed second reading after a closure motion June 2, 2026 and was referred to the Standing Committee on Justice Policy. NOT yet law as of mid-June 2026.

A 16-schedule public-safety omnibus. Notably it amends the Community Safety and Policing Act to require the OPP Commissioner to publish offenders' personal information on a publicly accessible website (a high-risk/sex-offender 'community notification' database, targeted to launch ~April 2027); amends the Police Record Checks Reform Act to let police chiefs designate 'authorized bodies' for record checks; reforms the sex-offender registry (Christopher's Law); restricts towing near collisions; gives transit special constables power to stop illegal drug use; offers up to \$50,000 debt relief for trafficking victims; and (per government messaging) addresses government drone procurement and corrections.

FOR

Government and many victims'-advocates support tougher tools against human trafficking, illegal-drug production and transit disorder, plus debt relief for trafficking survivors. Public-notification supporters argue communities have a right to know about high-risk offenders nearby.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

High and direct: mandated publication of named individuals' personal information on a public website is a significant state disclosure of sensitive data; police-record-check changes and broader policing powers add surveillance/data concerns. Expect Information and Privacy Commissioner scrutiny.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties and privacy advocates warn that a government-run public website naming offenders can cause vigilantism, mistaken identity, permanent reputational harm and re-offending pressure, and may exceed what courts have allowed for offender disclosure. Expanded police record-check pathways and special-constable drug-enforcement powers raise over-reach and discrimination concerns.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People with criminal records (and those mistaken for them); trafficking survivors; transit riders and special constables; the towing industry; police services; the general public.

Bill 75 Keeping Criminals Behind Bars Act, 2026 WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Michael S. Kerzner, Solicitor General (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received June 2, 2026; Statutes of Ontario 2026, c. 7.

Seven-schedule justice/public-safety law. Its Bail Act provisions let courts register a lien against an accused's (or surety's) real property to secure bail and enforce forfeiture through property sale, tightening the financial side of bail. It also: imposes indefinite licence suspensions and impoundment for dangerous driving causing death and stiffer distracted-driving penalties for commercial drivers (Highway Traffic Act); sets service standards for police record-check providers; raises penalties for harming police animals (min. \$50,000); restricts invasive research on cats/dogs; bars photography/recording at coroner's inquests; and continues a scholarship fund for families of public-safety officers killed on duty.

FOR

Supporters say it strengthens public safety, deters dangerous driving, holds accused people to their bail conditions, improves animal welfare, and honours fallen first responders. Parts (animal-research limits, scholarship) drew broad support.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Mostly low/minimal on data privacy. The civil-liberties dimension is bail/liberty: financial bail conditions can mean wealth-based pre-trial detention. The ban on recording inquests slightly limits open-court transparency.

AGAINST

The Ontario Bar Association and defence lawyers cautioned that the upfront-payment/lien bail mechanism could disadvantage lower-income accused who cannot post cash or own property, undermining the constitutional presumption of reasonable bail and the presumption of innocence; bail is largely federal (Criminal Code), so the province's room to act is limited. 'Indefinite' licence suspensions raise proportionality questions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Accused persons and their sureties (especially those without assets); drivers; police-record-check applicants; researchers using animals; families of fallen officers.

Bill 101 Putting Student Achievement First Act, 2026 (school-board governance) WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Paul Calandra, Minister of Education (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received May 7, 2026.

Centralizes control over school boards. It caps the number of elected trustees per board, creates new financial-oversight and 'student achievement' roles, sharply narrows trustees' role, and makes it easier for the Education Minister to sideline elected trustees and appoint supervisors to run boards. It also changes school-board labour relations / collective bargaining. The province had already taken over several boards (e.g. Ottawa-Carleton, Toronto-area boards).

FOR

Government argues it improves financial accountability, fixes mismanaged/deficit boards, and gives students more consistent outcomes and a 'back to basics' focus. Some parents frustrated with board dysfunction welcome stronger oversight.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal direct privacy impact. The civil-liberties concern is democratic - reduced local electoral accountability over schools rather than data/surveillance.

AGAINST

Critics (teachers' unions, trustees' associations, education advocates) call it an anti-democratic centralization that removes locally elected oversight, weakens community/parental representation, and follows funding cuts in taken-over boards (e.g. a reported ~\$560/student drop in one board). Concerns it politicizes curriculum and bargaining.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Elected school trustees; parents and students; teachers and education unions; local communities; school-board employees.

Bill 100 Better Regional Governance Act, 2026 WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Rob Flack, Minister of Municipal Affairs and Housing (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received May 7, 2026; Statutes of Ontario 2026, c. 3.

Lets the province appoint (hand-pick) the regional chairs of Durham, Halton, Muskoka, Peel, Waterloo and York, plus the warden of Simcoe County, and gives those chairs 'strong chair' powers to control budgets, hire/fire senior staff and veto bylaws. It restructures Niagara Region and Simcoe County councils to be made up of lower-tier mayors and allows the Minister to require weighted voting.

FOR

Government argues appointed strong chairs streamline regional decision-making, speed up housing and infrastructure, and reduce duplication, consistent with its broader 'strong mayor' agenda.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy impact. Civil-liberties concern is democratic accountability and local self-government, not data/surveillance.

AGAINST

Municipal leaders, AMO members and the NDP (leader Marit Stiles called it a 'path to corruption') warn it removes democratic accountability by replacing elected regional chairs with provincial appointees who hold veto and spending power - concentrating power in the Premier's office over local government.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Residents of the affected regions (millions in the GTA/Golden Horseshoe); elected municipal/regional officials; municipal staff; developers and housing proponents.

Bill 33 Supporting Children and Students Act, 2025 WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Paul Calandra, Minister of Education (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received November 2025.

Education omnibus. It requires school boards to work with local police to give officers access to schools and to (re)implement School Resource Officer (SRO) programs; it amends the Ministry of Training, Colleges and Universities Act to require colleges and universities to admit based on 'merit' and publish admission criteria; and gives the province more control over student/ancillary fees and other school operations.

FOR

Government and some parents/police argue SROs improve school safety and relationships, and that 'merit-based' admissions with published criteria add transparency and fairness.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium: routine police presence in schools raises concerns about surveillance of minors, information-sharing between schools and police, and students' interactions being documented. Equity/discrimination is the central civil-liberties issue.

AGAINST

The Ontario Human Rights Commission, education researchers and student groups warn the SRO mandate revives a 'school-to-prison pipeline' that disproportionately harms Black, Indigenous and racialized and disabled students (many boards had removed SROs after equity reviews), and that the 'merit' admissions language could be used to roll back equity/diversity considerations and erode campus autonomy and student rights.

WHO IT AFFECTS

K-12 students (especially racialized, Indigenous and disabled students) and parents; school boards; police; college/university applicants and institutions; student unions.

Bill 105 Protecting Ontario's Workers and Economic Resilience Act, 2026 (the 'POWER Act') LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Andrea Khanjin, Minister of Red Tape Reduction (PC) · Status: In committee / advancing - reported back as amended by the Standing Committee on Finance and Economic Affairs (May 2026); not yet law as of mid-June 2026.

Labour and workplace omnibus. It would restore injured-worker Loss of Earnings and survivor benefits from 85% to 90% of pre-injury net earnings (reversing 1998 cuts), bar employers from charging workers for required uniforms/cleaning, enact a new Strengthening Talent Agency Regulation (STAR) Act to protect entertainment workers from talent agencies, and amend the Employment Standards Act, Labour Relations Act, Occupational Health and Safety Act and WSIA. It also shortens the construction-sector union 'open period' to one month.

FOR

Worker advocates welcome the WSIB benefit restoration and the uniform-cost and talent-agency protections. Government frames it as supporting workers and economic resilience amid tariffs.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy implications.

AGAINST

Some unions and worker-side analysts call parts a 'Trojan horse,' arguing the shortened construction open period entrenches incumbent unions and limits workers' freedom to change representation, and that WSIB changes are mixed. Employer groups flag added compliance costs.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Injured workers and survivors; all employees who wear required uniforms; entertainment/talent workers; construction workers and unions; employers across Ontario.

Bill 40 Protect Ontario by Securing Affordable Energy for Generations Act, 2025 LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Stephen Lecce, Minister of Energy and Mines (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received December 11, 2025.

Energy-sector law. It adds 'economic growth consistent with government policy' as a formal objective of the Ontario Energy Board and the Electricity Act, creates tools to plan for large electricity loads (e.g. data centres) and infrastructure, supports nuclear expansion (small modular reactors at Darlington) and a low-carbon hydrogen fund, enables new restrictions on 'hostile foreign participants' in the energy sector, and strengthens the OEB CEO's power to set hearing timelines/procedures.

FOR

Supporters cite energy security, support for clean/nuclear power and electrification, readiness for surging demand (AI/data centres), faster regulatory decisions, and protection against hostile foreign ownership.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy implications.

AGAINST

Critics worry that baking 'government policy' into the energy regulator's objectives and boosting the CEO's control over hearings could politicize the OEB and reduce independent, evidence-based ratepayer protection; some question the cost and pace of the nuclear/SMR bet and accommodation of large industrial loads.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Electricity ratepayers; nuclear/hydrogen and data-centre industries; the Ontario Energy Board; foreign energy investors; long-term energy and climate planning.

Bill 114 HST Relief Implementation Act (Residential Property Rebates), 2026 RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Peter Bethlenfalvy, Minister of Finance (PC) · Status: Royal Assent / law - received May 12, 2026.

Implements provincial HST relief/rebates tied to residential property (a housing-affordability and cost-of-living measure), reducing the sales-tax burden on qualifying new/residential housing as part of the government's affordability and homebuilding push.

FOR

Provides tangible cost-of-living and housing-affordability relief; supports new-home construction and first-time/new buyers; broadly popular across parties as relief.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy implications.

AGAINST

Critics question whether tax rebates meaningfully improve affordability versus boosting prices or mainly benefiting developers/higher-value buyers, and note the foregone provincial revenue. Effectiveness depends on design and pass-through.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Homebuyers (especially of new residential property); homebuilders/developers; the provincial treasury; the broader housing market.

National Assembly of Quebec (Assemblée nationale du Québec)

Session: 43rd Legislature, 3rd Session — opened 5 May 2026, adjourned sine die 12 June 2026 (the preceding 2nd Session ran 30 Sept 2025 — 8 April 2026)
 Government: Coalition Avenir Québec (CAQ) — MAJORITY (79 of 125 seats). Premier: Christine Fréchette, who took office 15 April 2026 after François Legault resigned as CAQ leader. Opposition: Quebec Liberal Party (PLQ) ~18, Québec solidaire (QS) ~11, Parti Québécois (PQ) ~7, plus independents and 1 Conservative.

CONTEXT: This was the CAQ's final session before the fixed-date general election of 5 October 2026, held under brand-new Premier Christine Fréchette (sworn in 15 April 2026 after François Legault stepped down as CAQ leader). The Assembly adjourned sine die on 12 June 2026; with an election looming, the CAQ pushed a packed agenda (the government spoke of passing ~16 bills) and added extra sitting days, producing an end-of-session 'blitz' in which numerous bills were sanctioned in the final 48 hours.

KEY OUTCOMES: Passed/sanctioned include Bill 3 (electoral map, unanimous), Bill 4 (Clare's Law), Bill 9 (energy drinks), Bill 10 (consumer/ticket resale), Bill 22 (municipal powers), Bill 23 (forced hospitalization), Bill 24 (deepfakes), plus Bills 11 and 12 and a gutted Bill 17 (gas-storage, reduced to a pilot). Notably DIED on the order paper: Bill 1 (the proposed Quebec constitution) and Bill 5 (the Q-5 megaproject fast-track) — both flagship CAQ items the government vowed to revive if re-elected. Bill 20 (housing single window) was abandoned by the new housing minister. Bills 8 (language of vocational/adult education), 25 (judicial ethics) and 27 (collective-agreement decrees/construction) stalled at presentation and did not become law this session.

ACCURACY CAVEATS: (1) Bill numbers 1-27 originated in the 2nd Session (43-2) but were carried over/re-inscribed to this 3rd Session in May 2026; the official tracker threads them under their 43-2 page, which is why some sources cite that session. (2) Bill 2 (the notwithstanding-clause renewal for the language laws) — the Premier's signature opening bill — was adopted article-by-article in committee on 10 June 2026, but at the time of capture the official assnat.qc.ca tracker still showed it short of Royal Assent; its final adoption before the 12 June adjournment could not be independently confirmed here and should be re-checked on the official site. (3) Statuses reflect a mid-June 2026 snapshot; for any litigation-grade certainty, confirm each bill's 'cheminement' page on assnat.qc.ca and the chapter number in the Gazette officielle / Publications du Québec.

SOURCES: Primary — Assemblée nationale du Québec (assnat.qc.ca) bill list and individual bill pages for the 43rd Legislature, 3rd Session, and the Bibliothèque de l'Assemblée nationale. Secondary/analysis — CBC News, La Presse, Le Devoir, Radio-Canada, Actualité politique du Québec (APDQ); civil-society/expert input from the Commission des droits de la personne et des droits de la jeunesse (CDPDJ memoir on Bill 4), the Barreau du Québec, Ligue des droits et libertés, AGIDD-SMQ/RRASMQ (Bill 23), the Centre québécois du droit de l'environnement and Nature Québec (Bill 5), the Canadian Civil Liberties Association (notwithstanding clause), and sector groups (FHCQ, RSIQ, APEQ, FAE, FTQ, CAVAC).

Bill 2 Renewal of the notwithstanding clause for Quebec's language laws (Bill 101 / Bill 96) HIGH CONCERN

Status: Adopted article-by-article in committee 10 June 2026 (CAQ votes); the official tracker still showed it at 'report tabled — detailed study' and NOT yet at Royal Assent (Sanction) at the time of capture, so final adoption/assent before the 12 June adjournment is not independently confirmed here.

Premier Fréchette's surprise opening bill. It re-invokes, five years early, the 'parliamentary sovereignty' (notwithstanding) clauses in the Charter of the French Language and the Official and Common Language Act, extending to 2031 the shield that blocks court challenges to Quebec's language laws under the Canadian Charter of Rights and Freedoms (and, in the government's version, the Quebec Charter too).

FOR

Government and many nationalists call it a legitimate 'national affirmation' tool used by governments of all stripes; it gives legal stability to Bill 96 measures (CEGEP enrolment caps, francization of businesses with 25-49 employees) and pre-empts litigation. The PLQ itself conceded the clause is a legitimate instrument historically.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Privacy impact is minimal/indirect, but civil-liberties impact is central: by overriding Charter ss.2 and 7-15 protections (freedom of expression, equality, etc.) for five years, it removes Quebecers' ability to have language-law rights violations reviewed by the courts.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties groups (e.g., the Canadian Civil Liberties Association) warn that pre-emptive, blanket and now habitual use of s.33 causes a 'slow death of the Charter,' immunizing rights violations from judicial review. QS wanted to keep derogation from the federal Charter but remove it from the Quebec Charter so citizens could still sue provincially; that amendment was rejected. Critics note Bill 96's rules remain ill-suited to First Nations realities, with no fix included. Timing (months before an election) was called partisan.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anglophone and allophone Quebecers, English-language CEGEP applicants, small businesses (25-49 employees) facing francization, and anyone wishing to challenge a language law in court; First Nations communities flagged as ill-served.

Bill 4 Act respecting the communication of information to protect against intimate-partner violence ('Gabie Renaud Law' / Quebec's 'Clare's Law') WATCH

Status: Passed — received Royal Assent (sanctioned) on/about 11 June 2026.

Modelled on England's 'Clare's Law,' it lets a person who feels at risk request, via an online form processed by the Sûreté du Québec, disclosure of a current or prospective intimate partner's relevant criminal/judicial history. Information is conveyed verbally through a designated support organization, with about \$27.6M over five years and 23 added SQ staff in year one. Also covers minors aged 14+.

FOR

Aims to prevent femicides and conjugal violence by giving potential victims information to assess danger; backed by the family/victim advocacy sector and inspired by a real femicide case. The Quebec Human Rights Commission (CDPDJ) and the Barreau du Québec broadly support the objective; CDPDJ praises that it pairs the at-risk person's decisional autonomy with adapted psychosocial support.

AGAINST

Victim-support centres (CAVAC) warn an empty police record can create a false sense of security because most domestic violence never reaches the courts. Mandatory youth-protection (DPJ) reporting tied to the regime could deter mothers from asking for fear of losing custody. A legal requirement to destroy disclosed information clashes with professionals' duty to document risk assessments. Many operational details are deferred to future regulation; experts doubt 21-23 staff can handle ~10,000 requests/year. The CDPDJ urged clearer guardrails and a mandatory evaluation of the law's implementation.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Significant. The scheme discloses a third party's criminal/police-held personal information to a private individual, raising questions about accuracy and currency of police data, presumption of innocence, proportionality, data-handling/destruction, and potential misuse (e.g., to surveil or stigmatize an ex-partner). The CDPDJ stresses tight balises (limits) are needed so disclosure stays proportionate and is properly overseen.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People (mostly women) who fear an intimate partner; the partners whose records are disclosed; minors 14+; the SQ and designated victim-support organizations.

Bill 23 Act to better support persons whose mental state may present a danger (reform of the 'P-38' forced-hospitalization law) HIGH CONCERN

Status: Passed — adopted on division and sanctioned ~12 June 2026.

First major overhaul in roughly 25-30 years of the law on involuntary psychiatric hospitalization. It broadens the threshold from danger that is 'grave and immediate' to a 'situation where there is danger,' merges two detention regimes under a single administrative tribunal, and introduces advance psychiatric directives letting people set out wishes in advance of a crisis.

FOR

Government and family/relative associations (e.g., CAP santé mentale, representing 55 groups) call it crucial — allowing earlier intervention 'before it's too late,' modernizing an outdated regime, and adding advance directives that respect patient preferences. The government says it will not increase the overall number of forced hospitalizations.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties and mental-health groups (Ligue des droits et libertés, AGIDD-SMQ, RRASMQ) say lowering the danger threshold makes it easier to detain people against their will, eroding fundamental rights. The Quebec Ombudsman (Protecteur du citoyen), the Collège des médecins and advocacy groups warned of disparate impacts on elderly, homeless and Indigenous people. Process criticized as rushed: ~91 pages of amendments tabled the same day study began, ~73 articles affecting fundamental rights examined in days. Over half of the \$104M/5 years goes to Justice rather than frontline mental-health care; only ~411 of ~6,000 provincial police were trained in mental health last year. An expert review (IQRDJ, Dec 2025) had urged keeping P-38's exceptional character and the immediate-danger test.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Civil-liberties impact is high (deprivation of liberty/bodily autonomy through involuntary confinement). Privacy-specific concerns are secondary but real: handling of sensitive psychiatric records, sharing of health information among police, hospitals and the new tribunal, and the data underpinning risk assessments.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People experiencing mental-health crises (and disproportionately the elderly, homeless and Indigenous), their families, psychiatric facilities, police, and the new administrative tribunal.

Bill 24 Act protecting consumers against deceptive or fraudulent use of a person's identity or image (deepfakes / AI) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Status: Passed — sanctioned ~12 June 2026.

Targets AI-generated 'deepfake' scams that clone real people's faces/voices (celebrities and ordinary citizens) to push fraudulent ads and products. It empowers the Office de la protection du consommateur to order removal of such content and compels digital platforms to comply, with administrative penalties reaching up to ~5% of global revenue; the financial-markets regulator (AMF) also gets tools to act quickly without going to court.

FOR

Responds to a fast-growing harm (identity-theft losses cited around \$700M across Canada in 2025; named victims include public figures and individuals defrauded of tens of thousands). Gives a fast, court-free takedown path and real financial leverage over platforms; victim witnesses described lasting reputational damage.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Rights-positive for privacy and identity: it protects individuals against non-consensual use of their likeness, voice and identity and creates a mechanism to get fraudulent impersonations removed. No new state surveillance powers; data-handling for takedown requests is the main thing to watch.

AGAINST

Opposition argued platforms that profit from hosting the scams still face no direct liability for facilitating them, and that there is no centralized victim-support system — victims must navigate multiple agencies. Enforcement against global platforms and cross-border fraudsters is untested.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Consumers and fraud victims, people whose image/voice is misused (celebrities and ordinary citizens), digital platforms, advertisers, and Quebec's consumer and financial regulators.

Bill 5 Act to accelerate the authorizations required to carry out priority projects of national scope ('Q-5' megaproject fast-track) HIGH CONCERN

Status: DIED on the order paper (mort au feuillet) at the end of session, June 2026 — not adopted. The CAQ says it will reintroduce it in the fall if re-elected.

Sponsored by Finance Minister Eric Girard, it would have created a single, expedited authorization track for projects the Finance Minister designates 'priority/national scope' (e.g., large infrastructure, the battery/EV supply chain), letting Cabinet modify or suspend Quebec laws — including environmental statutes — for those projects.

FOR

Government framed it as boosting the economy, jobs and Quebec's 'autonomy' and resilience, cutting red tape, and speeding strategic projects while nominally respecting environmental review, public health/safety and Indigenous rights, with collaboration among ministries, municipalities and Indigenous communities.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Privacy: minimal. The serious concerns are democratic accountability, environmental protection, and Indigenous consultation/consent — concentrating discretionary power in Cabinet and shrinking public participation and oversight.

AGAINST

The Quebec Environmental Law Centre (CQDE), Nature Québec, the Centre québécois du droit de l'environnement and the Fédération québécoise des municipalités warned it handed Cabinet sweeping power to bypass environmental law with no expiry on exemptions ('regulatory free passes for up to 100 years'), gave the Environment Ministry no added funding or inspection capacity, and cut public-consultation windows from 45 to 20 days, making meaningful local input nearly impossible. Most opposition safeguard amendments were rejected; QS 'obstruction' was blamed by the government for the bill's death.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Communities near major projects, environmental and Indigenous groups, municipalities, project proponents/industry, and the Environment Ministry.

Bill 1 Constitutional Act of 2025 respecting Quebec (a written Quebec constitution) HIGH CONCERN

Status: DIED on the order paper — abandoned 11 June 2026 by Justice Minister Simon Jolin-Barrette; will not be adopted this Parliament.

Would have codified a written Quebec constitution by ordinary legislation, asserting provincial autonomy: directives letting the Quebec government instruct state bodies to refuse federal cooperation on certain matters, and a proposed Quebec Constitutional Council to assess perceived federal overreach. An early abortion-rights provision was added then removed.

FOR

Supporters argued it would entrench Quebec's distinct identity and strengthen resistance to federal centralization (citing B.C.'s 1996 constitution as precedent for using ordinary legislation).

AGAINST

The Barreau du Québec warned provisions could threaten the separation of powers, muzzle checks and balances, create legal instability and weaken fundamental rights. Hundreds of civil-society groups (including the FTQ labour federation) demanded full withdrawal; Indigenous nations criticized their 'phantom' treatment in the text. The minister's framing of public participation as 'obstruction' drew further criticism. Attempts to water it down failed and it collapsed.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Privacy: minimal. The civil-liberties concerns were structural — separation of powers, judicial oversight, legal certainty, fundamental-rights protection and Indigenous rights.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Quebecers (constitutional architecture and rights), the judiciary, Indigenous nations, civil-society and labour groups, and federal-provincial relations.

Bill 3 Act to ensure effective representation of electors (electoral-map redistricting, 125 to 127 ridings) RIGHTS-

POSITIVE

Status: Passed — adopted unanimously and sanctioned 12 June 2026; in force for the 5 October 2026 election.

Increases the National Assembly from 125 to 127 seats and reworks riding boundaries (combining 115 ridings from the new electoral-commission map with 12 from the old map). It responds to a Supreme Court ruling that struck down a 2024 law for under-representing fast-growing regions (Laurentides/central Quebec), while preserving seats in the Gaspé and east-end Montreal.

FOR

Brings the map into line with the constitutional right to effective representation; adopted with all-party support (CAQ, PLQ, PQ, QS), protecting both growing regions and lower-population regions/Montreal seats.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Adds two more politicians/seats (a modest cost), and some MNAs questioned specific boundary choices; balancing regional representation against voter-parity is inherently contested.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Quebec voters and the regional balance of representation; candidates and parties for the October 2026 election.

Bill 8 Act respecting the language of instruction in vocational training and general adult education (extending Bill 101) WATCH

Status: Did not pass — remained at first reading (presentation) when the session ended; effectively stalled/pending (the CAQ would need to reintroduce it).

Tabled by French-Language Minister Jean-François Roberge in June 2026, it would extend the Charter of the French Language to vocational training and general adult education, barring students who are not 'eligible persons' from studying in English-language programs, with a proposed in-force date of 30 June 2028.

FOR

Government and language advocates frame it as closing a gap in Bill 101 and reinforcing French in workforce training.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal on privacy; civil-liberties concern is around equality and access to education/credentials, plus impacts on anglophone and Indigenous learners.

AGAINST

The Quebec Provincial Association of Teachers (APEQ) warned it would sharply reduce education access for thousands of adults seeking diplomas/qualifications; the autonomous teachers' federation (FAE) questioned the network's capacity to deliver. First Nations organizations warned it adds barriers to educational success for Indigenous learners.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Adult learners and vocational students (especially anglophones and immigrants seeking credentials), First Nations learners, and adult/vocational education institutions.

Bill 20 Act to promote access to housing (single window for low-cost/affordable housing)

WATCH

Status: ABANDONED — new Housing Minister Karine Boivin Roy confirmed the government would not bring it back; not adopted.

Tabled in early 2026, it would have created a single, mandatory intake-and-allocation window for low-cost and 'affordable' housing, including the rent-supplement program (PSL), to streamline how units are assigned.

FOR

Pitched as cutting administrative duplication and speeding access to housing amid the affordability crisis; a single window could simplify applications for tenants.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Modest: a centralized housing-allocation database would concentrate sensitive tenant data (income, household details), raising data-protection and profiling questions — but since the bill was abandoned, this did not materialize.

AGAINST

Housing co-operatives (FHCQ) strongly opposed mandatory central allocation as a threat to their autonomy to select members/tenants, and feared financial penalties on tenants whose income exceeded thresholds. The homelessness network (RSIQ) and others also raised concerns. The new minister cited lack of time to meet partners' expectations and dropped it.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Low-income tenants and applicants, housing co-operatives and non-profits, and municipalities/housing agencies.

Bill 10 Act protecting consumers against abusive ticket-resale and online-subscription practices

RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Status: Passed — sanctioned; key provisions take effect 12 September 2026 (bill was re-inscribed to the 3rd Session on 6 May 2026 and completed).

Sponsored by Justice Minister Simon Jolin-Barrette, it cracks down on abusive ticket resale (transparency about resale platforms and ticket details; bans fees for transferring a show ticket) and on 'subscription traps' (an easy online cancellation/cancel button' and restitution obligations), enforced through the Consumer Protection Act with administrative monetary penalties.

FOR

Concrete consumer relief: curbs scalping/hidden resale, stops fees on ticket transfers, and makes it easy to cancel online subscriptions; broadly welcomed (with refinements suggested by the music industry/ADISQ).

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal — generally rights-positive for consumers; the main consideration is fair handling of consumer data by platforms and the regulator.

AGAINST

Mostly technical debate over scope and enforcement; limited controversy.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Consumers buying event tickets and online subscriptions, resale platforms, ticketing companies, and subscription businesses.

Bill 9 Act to prevent the harmful effects of energy drinks on youth health

LOWER CONCERN

Status: Passed — adopted 11 June 2026 and sanctioned.

Restricts the sale of caffeinated 'energy drinks' to people under 16 (and tightens marketing/availability to youth) as a public-health measure.

FOR

Public-health rationale: limits youth exposure to high-caffeine products; popular protective measure for minors.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal — possible age-verification at point of sale is the only data-touch point.

AGAINST

Critics question enforceability and whether age limits are the right tool versus broader regulation/education; minor paternalism debate and retail-compliance costs.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Minors under 16, parents, retailers, and beverage manufacturers.

Bill 25 Act to increase public confidence in the justice system by modernizing judicial ethics (and judges' remuneration measures) WATCH

Status: Did not pass — remained at first reading (presentation) at session's end; stalled/pending.

Sponsored by Justice Minister Simon Jolin-Barrette, it would broaden the sanctions the Conseil de la magistrature can impose on judges for ethics breaches — currently essentially reprimand or recommend removal — to add options like ordered training/therapy, formal apologies and suspension, plus more transparent complaint-handling and implementation of 2023-2027 judges' pay recommendations.

FOR

The Barreau du Québec welcomed it as an important step to preserve public confidence in the courts; gives a graduated, more credible range of discipline instead of an all-or-nothing choice.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal on personal privacy; the civil-liberties dimension is institutional — judicial independence, due process for judges, and public transparency of complaints.

AGAINST

Some asked why the CAQ waited years to act on a long-flagged problem. More fundamentally, expanding the executive/justice minister's role in judicial discipline touches judicial independence and separation of powers, which must be handled carefully.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Judges, complainants and litigants, the Conseil de la magistrature, and public confidence in the justice system.

British Columbia BC

Legislative Assembly of British Columbia

Session: 43rd Parliament, 2nd Session. Opened February 17, 2026; the spring sitting is ongoing as of June 2026 (most government bills cleared by late May 2026; a number received Royal Assent around May 28, 2026).

Government: Governing party: BC New Democratic Party (BC NDP). Premier: David Eby. Status: technically a MAJORITY, but a razor-thin one — NDP hold roughly 47 of 93 seats (commonly described as a "one-vote majority"), with the BC Conservatives the Official Opposition (~44 seats, leader Trevor Halford since Dec 2025), 2 BC Greens, and several Independents (caucus departures have eroded the original margin). The thin margin shaped the session: the government dropped its planned DRIPA suspension after an NDP MLA refused to support it.

SESSION CONTEXT: The spring 2026 sitting (43rd Parliament, 2nd Session) was dominated by (a) economic/trade-barrier and project 'fast-tracking' legislation, (b) a cluster of transparency/executive-power fights driven by the Eby government's recent court losses, and (c) Indigenous reconciliation flashpoints.

KEY 'DOG THAT DIDN'T BARK': The government's most-watched planned move — legislation to SUSPEND or amend the Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples Act (DRIPA) / related Interpretation Act provisions after a December 2025 BC Court of Appeal ruling (mineral-rights/Cowichan-related) requiring all BC laws to be read through a DRIPA lens — was DROPPED. Eby initially called the changes 'non-negotiable' and floated a confidence vote, but after NDP MLA Joan Phillip (Vancouver-Strathcona) signalled she would not support it and the First Nations Leadership Council formally opposed it, the Premier's office confirmed on April 19, 2026 it would not be introduced this spring. This is the clearest illustration of the NDP's fragile one-vote majority and is essential civil-liberties/Indigenous-rights context even though no bill resulted.

TRANSPARENCY/EXECUTIVE-POWER THEME: Bill 9 (FOIPPA) and Bill 16 (cabinet-confidence/judicial-review changes) together drew sustained criticism (FIPA, The Tyee, the Narwhal, opposition parties) as a pattern of the executive insulating itself from scrutiny after losing in court. The Information and Privacy Commissioner's support for Bill 9 is genuinely contested by access advocates and should not be read as a clean bill of health.

NUMBERING NOTE: Bill 1 ('An Act to Ensure the Supremacy of Parliament') is the routine PRO FORMA bill the Attorney General introduces at the start of every BC session to assert the Assembly's independence — it is NOT substantive legislation and was excluded; some early news write-ups conflated it with the judicial-power dispute, which actually lives in Bill 16. Supply Acts (Bills 4, 22) and Budget Measures Implementation Acts (Bills 2, 3) are routine money/budget bills and were excluded as technical. Other excluded items are commemorative or narrow private member's bills (most M-bills), several of which never advance past first reading.

CAVEATS: Statuses reflect the end of the main spring sitting (late May 2026). The official progress-of-bills page showed most government bills (2,3,5,6,7,8,9,10,11,12,13,14,15,16,20,22) reaching third reading; confirmed-in-force/assented items include Bill 8 (eff. Feb 23, 2026), Bill 10 (Royal Assent Apr 16, 2026) and Bill 20/K'ómoks (Royal Assent May 28, 2026). For bills where I could not independently pin an exact Royal Assent date, the status field says so. Verify any single bill on leg.bc.ca or BC Laws before relying on it for a deadline-sensitive purpose.

KEY SOURCES: leg.bc.ca (bills/progress of bills), BC Laws (bill texts/alpha list), BC Gov News releases, plus reporting/analysis from The Tyee, The Narwhal, Business in Vancouver/Rob Shaw, CBC, Daily Hive, Globe and Mail, JURIST, FIPA (fipa.bc.ca), Health Justice (healthjustice.ca), Ecojustice, West Coast Environmental Law, Yellowhead Institute, and law-firm bulletins (Lawson Lundell, DLA Piper, McCarthy Tétrault, Alexander Holburn, Ng Ariss Fong).

Bill 9 Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Amendment Act, 2026 (FOIPPA) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Diana Gibson, Minister of Citizens' Services (NDP) · Status: Passed third reading after committee-stage government amendments (committee late May 2026); Royal Assent at the end of the spring sitting (on/around May 28, 2026). Several substantive provisions take effect only later by regulation. (Treat exact assent date as late-May 2026.)

Rewrites BC's access-to-information and privacy law. Changes the duty to respond to FOI requests from 'without delay' to 'without unreasonable delay'; lets public bodies disregard requests deemed abusive, malicious, excessively broad, or repetitious/systematic; makes the 'head of public body' the judge of whether a request has enough detail; creates a new exemption for communications from judicial officers about proposed legislation or policy; and authorizes a government 'connected services' platform that lets public bodies share residents' personal information across an integrated digital service layer under ministerial direction. Also enables proactive release of people's own records without a formal request and lets the Information and Privacy Commissioner share information with other privacy regulators.

FOR

Government frames it as modernization for a high-volume digital era: faster handling of legitimate requests, relief from a documented minority of abusive/vexatious requesters, easier self-service access to your own records, and a one-stop digital services platform.

Notably, Information and Privacy Commissioner Michael Harvey said he was consulted and supports the changes, arguing they do not reduce his oversight.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Double-edged and significant. On civil-liberties/transparency: weakens the public's ability to hold government accountable through FOI. On data privacy: the 'connected services'/integrated data-sharing platform centralizes and shares personal information across public bodies under cabinet/ministerial direction, raising surveillance-adjacent and data-minimization concerns; safeguards are largely deferred to regulation. The commissioner's endorsement is contested by access advocates.

AGAINST

Heavily criticized as a 'stealth attack' on transparency. The BC Freedom of Information and Privacy Association (FIPA, Mike Larsen) says it shifts power from requesters to government and narrows public access; the BC Conservatives and BC Greens call it part of a years-long erosion of access rights. The 'disregard' grounds and 'head decides sufficiency' rules give government wide discretion to refuse; the judicial-communications exemption is seen as shielding government from scrutiny in policy disputes with the courts. Critics note the most contentious effects depend on future regulations passed without further legislative debate.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Journalists, researchers, opposition, lawyers, advocacy groups and ordinary citizens seeking government records; anyone whose personal data flows through provincial digital services.

Bill 16 Miscellaneous Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Government omnibus bill (Attorney General Niki Sharma / multiple ministries) · Status: Introduced April 1, 2026; advanced through the spring sitting to third reading / Royal Assent at the end of the sitting (late May 2026). Confirm exact assent date if precision is needed.

An omnibus bill bundling unrelated changes. Two items stand out. (1) It amends the Judicial Review Procedure Act to let government more easily certify and shield 'cabinet confidence' documents from disclosure during court challenges and protect officials from being compelled to testify about them — a response to court losses (e.g., the mink-farm phase-out litigation). (2) It amends the Correction Act to authorize provincial correctional officers to use physical force to help health-care providers administer involuntary treatment under the Mental Health Act. It also includes housing-cost and bylaw-ticketing (UEL) measures and tenancy housekeeping fixes.

FOR

Government says the judicial-review changes keep reviews 'fair, timely and affordable' and properly protect legitimate cabinet confidentiality; the corrections change purports to give legal clarity to situations already occurring. Housing measures aim to lower upfront building costs.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Cabinet-confidence provisions reduce transparency and the courts' ability to compel disclosure (accountability/civil-liberties concern). The corrections/involuntary-treatment provision is a bodily-autonomy and disability-rights concern, with documented transparency problems around involuntary treatment in BC.

AGAINST

Civil libertarians and the opposition see the cabinet-confidence provisions as a government insulating itself from accountability after losing in court — concentrating power in the executive and reducing what courts and the public can see. Health Justice warns the Correction Act change is the first BC law to expressly authorize force for involuntary psychiatric treatment, that the Mental Health Act itself never authorizes force, that it blurs punishment and health care, and that burying it in an omnibus bill dodged scrutiny.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Litigants challenging government decisions and the public's window into them; people detained in BC correctional facilities experiencing mental-health or substance-use crises; homebuilders and UEL residents.

Bill 15 Environmental Assessment Amendment Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Infrastructure / Environment; part of Eby's economic 'fast-track' agenda) · Status: Introduced March 31, 2026; reached third reading by the close of the spring sitting (late May 2026). Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Gives cabinet broad discretion to designate projects (mines, highways, other infrastructure) as 'provincially significant,' steering them into priority/expedited permitting and a narrower, 'high-risk-only' environmental assessment that can skip stages of the full process — potentially including some public-comment and cumulative/climate-impact analysis. Builds on the government's 2025 fast-tracking push (the 2025 Infrastructure Projects Act and Bill 14/15 controversy).

FOR

Government argues it speeds approvals for housing-enabling and economic infrastructure, attracts investment, and responds to tariff/economic pressure while preserving 'core' protections via the high-risk assessment and retained cabinet safeguards.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal direct privacy impact. Civil-liberties concern is procedural: reduced public participation and weakened Indigenous consultation/free-prior-informed-consent in environmental decision-making.

AGAINST

Ecojustice, West Coast Environmental Law, the Narwhal and others call it a 'blank cheque': undefined 'designated/provincially significant' categories, ability to bypass key assessment stages, weakened climate/cumulative-effects review, and reduced public input.

Indigenous critics and the Yellowhead Institute warn it can sidestep consultation obligations and undercut reconciliation commitments, with inadequate First Nations consultation before tabling.

WHO IT AFFECTS

First Nations with affected territories; communities near major projects; environmental and climate interests; project proponents and the resource/construction sectors.

Bill 8 Civil Forfeiture Amendment Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Public Safety and Solicitor General) · Status: Passed and in force — key provisions effective February 23, 2026. Now law.

Expands BC's civil (non-criminal) asset-forfeiture regime, implementing further Cullen Commission anti-money-laundering recommendations. Broadens the Civil Forfeiture Office's powers and the types of property that can be targeted, tightens administrative-forfeiture procedure (e.g., a 67-day window to dispute, harder to bring late claims), and shifts onus onto people defending property to provide detailed proof of their lawful interest. Sits alongside BC's controversial Unexplained Wealth Order powers.

FOR

Pitched as a tool to disrupt organized crime and money laundering by making it easier and faster for the state to seize proceeds of crime; supporters cite the Cullen Commission and BC's housing/fentanyl-linked laundering problems.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Property/due-process rights concern more than data privacy: forfeiture without conviction, reversed onus, and investigative financial scrutiny of individuals. Risk that people with no criminal conviction must prove the legitimacy of their assets.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties groups and defence lawyers warn it deepens an already aggressive regime that operates on a civil 'balance of probabilities' standard without a criminal conviction, effectively reversing the burden of proof onto property owners. Unexplained Wealth Orders (related regime) are already facing a Charter challenge as an unconstitutional inversion of normal civil procedure; Bill 8's tighter deadlines and onus-shifting compound due-process concerns.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone whose property is targeted by the Civil Forfeiture Office — including third parties and people never charged with a crime; targeted at organized crime but with broad reach.

Bill 11 Residential Tenancy Amendment Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Christine Boyle, Minister of Housing and Municipal Affairs (NDP) · Status: Passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026); some related Residential Tenancy Regulation changes already effective April 7, 2026. Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Creates a distinct, reduced category of tenancy rights for residents of 'supportive housing.' Adds new grounds for supportive-housing operators to end a tenancy (e.g., a weapon possessed or merely observed on the property) and lets operators restrict a tenant's access to their own unit before the Residential Tenancy Branch rules. Gives the housing minister and cabinet ongoing power to alter supportive-housing tenancy protections by regulation without returning to the legislature. Separate changes let operators of agreement-bound affordable units end tenancies of tenants who no longer income-qualify.

FOR

Government and some operators argue it improves safety in supportive housing (weapons, violence), helps providers manage complex sites, and that quick access-restriction tools protect staff and other vulnerable residents. Framed as part of the broader housing-safety push.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data-privacy impact. Strong civil-liberties/due-process concern: reduced eviction protections, pre-hearing access restriction (a form of de facto removal), and broad executive discretion affecting a vulnerable, often disabled and low-income population.

AGAINST

Tenant advocates (The Mainlander, IRPP/Policy Options analysis) warn it strips due-process rights from some of BC's most marginalized residents, enables eviction/lockout with weak safeguards, and hands cabinet permanent power to weaken protections without debate. Critics say 'weapon observed' is vague and ripe for abuse, and that creating a second-class tier of tenancy undermines security of tenure.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Residents of supportive and certain agreement-bound affordable housing (many with disabilities, mental-health or substance-use issues, or experiencing homelessness); housing operators.

Bill 13 Safe Access to Places of Public Worship Act WATCH

Sponsor: Government (Attorney General Niki Sharma / Premier's office; announced with Bill 12, March 9, 2026) · Status: Passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026); time-limited with a sunset (effective until 2030). Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Creates protest-free 'access zones' around places of worship (mosques, synagogues, temples, churches, etc.), prohibiting certain protest and disruptive activity near them. Responds to a rise in vandalism and intimidation at religious sites. Religious buildings must post a sign identifying themselves to trigger the zone. Companion to Bill 12, which extends similar 'safe access' protest restrictions around K-12 schools (originally enacted 2024) to 2028.

FOR

Aims to protect freedom of religion and safe community access against harassment, hate-motivated vandalism and intimidation; framed as a targeted, time-limited (sunset-clause) response to documented incidents, mirroring long-standing abortion-clinic 'bubble zone' models.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data-privacy impact. Direct civil-liberties tension between protection from harassment and freedom of assembly/expression near designated locations; effects depend on enforcement.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties advocates and the bills' critics frame this and Bill 12 as a creeping expansion of restrictions on Charter-protected peaceful protest and expression in public space. Concerns about how broadly 'disruption' is defined, enforcement discretion, and whether zones could capture legitimate political demonstration; the school version (Bill 12) drew similar objections.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Faith communities and worshippers (protection); protesters and demonstrators (restriction); police enforcing zones. (Bill 12 similarly affects school communities and protesters.)

Bill 7 Post-Secondary International Education (Designated Institutions) Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Post-Secondary Education and Future Skills) · Status: Introduced February 19, 2026; passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026). Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Puts BC's Education Quality Assurance (EQA) designation into statute and makes it a legal requirement for any public or private institution to host international students on federal study permits. Sets quality criteria, gives government inspection and enforcement powers, and prohibits non-designated institutions from advertising, enrolling, or delivering study-permit programs. Responds to abuse by low-quality 'diploma mill' private colleges amid the federal study-permit cap.

FOR

Protects international students from exploitative operators, upholds BC's education reputation, and adds real enforcement teeth where rules were previously just policy. Broadly welcomed as consumer/student protection in a sector worth ~\$4 billion to BC.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Inspection/enforcement powers involve institutional (not primarily personal) data; limited individual-privacy footprint.

AGAINST

Some private-sector and sector observers worry about compliance burden and government discretion over designations, and about downstream effects on enrolment and institutional viability under the federal cap. Largely seen as reasonable oversight rather than rights-infringing.

WHO IT AFFECTS

International students; public and private post-secondary institutions hosting them; the education-export sector.

Bill 5 Trade Recognition Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Diana Gibson, Minister of Jobs, Economic Development and Innovation (NDP) · Status: Passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026). Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Makes permanent BC's interprovincial recognition framework: goods, services and (via labour mobility) credentials lawfully accepted in another Canadian province are recognized in BC unless a specific exception applies. Replaces the temporary tariff-response measure (ESTRA) with a permanent regime, with cabinet retaining power to set exceptions to protect health, safety, consumer and environmental standards, and all BC exceptions posted publicly.

FOR

Reduces interprovincial trade and labour-mobility barriers — lower costs, faster market access, more consumer choice, and easier credential portability for workers moving to BC. Part of a national push (paralleling federal Bill C-5/One Canadian Economy) and broadly supported across parties as pro-worker and pro-consumer; transparency via public exceptions list.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Critics (incl. some opposition MLAs) question whether automatic recognition could erode BC-specific standards, and whether cabinet's exception power is exercised transparently and quickly enough. Concerns are mostly about implementation and standards, not rights.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Workers seeking credential/labour mobility into BC; businesses selling across provinces; consumers (prices/choice); regulators of standards.

Bill 10 Labour Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Labour) · Status: Received Royal Assent April 16, 2026; comes into force by regulation. Now law (pending proclamation of some parts).

Restructures how the Employment Standards Branch screens, investigates, resolves and appeals workplace complaints from non-unionized workers and temporary foreign workers (core entitlements unchanged). Gives the Director clearer grounds to dismiss complaints that are out of scope, frivolous, or already settled, and speeds transfer of unclaimed wages to workers via Unclaimed BC. Commentary also notes new appeal-process features described by some as 'pay-to-appeal.'

FOR

Aims to clear backlogs and get owed wages to workers faster, with more efficient handling of straightforward complaints — generally framed as worker-protective administrative modernization.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Worker advocates and some employment lawyers caution that broad dismissal discretion and any fee/'pay-to-appeal' element could deter legitimate complaints or reduce access to remedies; effects depend on regulations. Applies to the most precarious workers (non-union, temporary foreign workers).

WHO IT AFFECTS

Non-unionized employees, temporary foreign workers, and employers dealing with employment-standards complaints and appeals.

Bill 20 K'ómoks Treaty Act (companion: Bill 21, Kitselas Treaty Act) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Indigenous Relations and Reconciliation) · Status: Bill 20 received Royal Assent May 28, 2026 (provincial ratification complete; awaits federal ratification by Parliament of Canada). Bill 21 (Kitselas) introduced April 14, 2026 and advanced in the spring sitting, with further provincial ratification steps anticipated; confirm Bill 21's exact stage.

Implements modern treaties: Bill 20 ratifies the K'ómoks Treaty and Bill 21 the Kitselas Treaty. They establish government-to-government relationships, recognize rights and title, provide self-government powers (including administration of justice and enforcement of Nation laws), land, and funding. K'ómoks would become BC's ninth modern-treaty Nation after federal ratification.

FOR

Advance reconciliation and self-determination after decades of negotiation; supporters say they provide certainty for land and resource management and economic opportunity in the regions. Backed by the treaty Nations and the BC Treaty Commission.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data-privacy impact. Rights dimension is positive for the treaty Nations' self-determination; contested by Nations asserting overlapping rights.

AGAINST

Several neighbouring/overlapping First Nations (Wei Wai Kum, Nine Allied Tribes, Lax Kw'alaams, with UBCIC support) say the treaties infringe their traditional territories, asked for a 180-day pause, and are prepared to litigate — raising overlapping-claims and consultation concerns. The BC Greens flagged process issues at second reading.

WHO IT AFFECTS

K'ómoks and Kitselas First Nations and their members; neighbouring First Nations with overlapping claims; regional residents, governments and resource users.

Bill 14 Forests Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Ministry of Forests) · Status: Passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026); in force on/by Royal Assent. Confirm exact assent date if precision is needed.

Amends the Forest Act and Forest and Range Practices Act to broaden permitted 'fibre-generating' and stewardship activities. Lets BC Timber Sales issue licences covering commercial thinning, salvage of damaged/wildfire-killed trees, and wildfire-risk reduction, and creates a new 'contract logging authorization' a timber sales manager can issue.

FOR

Supports forestry jobs and contractor opportunities, enables wildfire-risk reduction and salvage of damaged timber, and adds flexibility to a sector under economic pressure.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Environmental and some Indigenous observers watch for cumulative logging impacts, adequacy of stewardship safeguards, and whether expanded BCTS activity comes with sufficient ecological and consultation guardrails. Mostly an operational/economic measure rather than a rights bill.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Forestry workers and contractors, BC Timber Sales, forest-dependent communities, and (indirectly) ecosystems and First Nations in affected areas.

Bill 12 Safe Access to Schools Amendment Act, 2026 WATCH

Sponsor: Government (Attorney General Niki Sharma / Premier's office; announced March 9, 2026 with Bill 13) · Status: Passed/advanced through the spring sitting (third reading by late May 2026); extends existing school protest restrictions (sunset to 2028). Confirm Royal Assent date if precision is needed.

Extends to 2028 the 'safe access' protest restrictions around K-12 schools first enacted in 2024 (the Safe Access to Schools Act), maintaining 'access zones' that prohibit certain protest/disruptive activity near school property. Companion to Bill 13 (places of worship).

FOR

Protects students' and educators' safe, uninterrupted access to schools amid disruptive demonstrations (notably those targeting 2SLGBTQ+-inclusive education); time-limited via a sunset clause and an extension of an existing, already-operating regime.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal data-privacy impact; direct tension between school-community safety and freedom of assembly/expression.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties advocates warn it continues and entrenches limits on peaceful protest and expression in public space near schools, with concerns about breadth of 'disruption,' enforcement discretion, and the precedent of expanding designated no-protest zones (alongside Bill 13).

WHO IT AFFECTS

Students, teachers and school communities (protection); protesters and demonstrators near schools (restriction); police.

Legislative Assembly of Alberta

Session: 31st Legislature, 2nd Session. The session opened in fall 2025; the spring sitting ran roughly late February to May 14, 2026, when it adjourned after passing 17 bills. (Bill PDFs carry a 2025-10-23 first-session-day stamp because the fall and spring sittings are the same 2nd Session.)

Government: United Conservative Party (UCP), majority government. Premier Danielle Smith. No general election in 2026; Smith publicly ruled out a spring 2026 election.

Session context: The 31st Legislature's 2nd Session spring sitting (late Feb-May 14, 2026) was dominated by Premier Smith's 'provincial sovereignty/autonomy' agenda and a planned October 2026 referendum (separation plus immigration-control and constitutional questions) more than by the bills themselves. The UCP majority passed 17 bills and, per multiple outlets, 'voted down every proposal brought forward by the opposition NDP' (e.g., Bill 204 whistleblower protection and Bill 209 consumer protection were defeated). A government motion also created a Select Special Committee on Electoral Boundaries (chaired by MLA Brandon Lundy) after the UCP declined to accept the independent boundaries commission's majority report - opposition calls this an illegitimate, partisan redrawing of the electoral map; this is a democratic-accountability concern even though it is a motion, not a bill. Verification caveats: (1) Bill PDFs on assembly.ab.ca carry a 2025-10-23 stamp (the 2nd Session's first sitting day), but the major numbered bills above (15, 18, 25-31) were introduced and debated in the spring 2026 sitting. (2) I confirmed Royal Assent dates for Bill 15 (Apr 16), Bill 28 (May 14), and third-reading passage of Bill 18 (Apr 22). Bills 25, 26, 29, 30 and 31 were part of the passed 17-bill suite and would have received Royal Assent on or about the May 14 wrap-up, but the official bill pages did not surface a separate per-bill assent date in my checks - treat those specific assent dates as 'passed/Royal Assent in the spring sitting' rather than independently date-stamped. Anyone needing exact dates should check the per-bill status page and the Proclamations list on alberta.ca, since several Acts are in force only on proclamation. Other notable items not broken out as separate bills above but referenced in session coverage: a new 'Care-First' auto-insurance system with adjusted rate caps (effective Jan 1, 2027), Animal Protection Act updates, consumer-protection measures on misleading tourism fees, and the launch of the Alberta Sheriffs Police Service (Bill 15). Civil-liberties hotspots this session: library/classroom censorship (Bills 25 and 28), two-tier health care (Bill 29), MAID restriction (Bill 18), expanded executive/ministerial power over municipalities and project approvals (Bills 28 and 30), and a new provincial policing entity (Bill 15).

Bill 18 Safeguards for Last Resort Termination of Life Act (MAID) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Justice Minister / Government (UCP) · Status: Passed third reading April 22, 2026; received Royal Assent in the spring sitting. Comes into force on proclamation. (Official site confirms the bill; third-reading passage widely reported.)

Adds provincial 'safeguards' to medical assistance in dying. It restricts/eliminates so-called 'Track 2' MAID (people whose natural death is NOT reasonably foreseeable), and would prohibit MAID for minors (including mature minors), people whose sole underlying condition is mental illness, advance requests, and adults lacking decision-making capacity. Some reporting describes limiting access to patients with a foreseeable death within ~12 months.

FOR

Supporters (including some faith-based and disability-rights groups, e.g. CCCC) argue it adds protective guardrails against premature or coerced deaths, especially for people with disabilities, mental illness, or those who may feel pressured by poverty or inadequate care; reasserts caution where federal expansion has been contested.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Largely about eligibility, not surveillance. Civil-liberties concern is bodily autonomy and the s.7 right to choose the timing/manner of one's death rather than data privacy. Possible compelled disclosure of diagnosis/capacity to assessors, but no new mass-data regime. Privacy proper: Minimal; autonomy: significant.

AGAINST

Critics argue Alberta is overriding/curtailing a right the Supreme Court (Carter) recognized and that federal law permits, potentially forcing suffering patients to endure prolonged decline or seek care elsewhere; raises division-of-powers and Charter questions (s.7 life/liberty/security). Restricting Track 2 narrows access already available federally.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Terminally and chronically ill Albertans seeking MAID (especially Track 2 / non-foreseeable-death patients), people with disabilities and mental illness, mature minors, families, and physicians/nurse practitioners who assess and provide MAID.

Bill 25 An Act to Remove Politics and Ideology from Classrooms and Amend the Education Act, 2026 HIGH

CONCERN

Sponsor: Demetrios Nicolaidis, Minister of Education and Childcare (UCP) · Status: Introduced March 31, 2026; passed and received Royal Assent in the spring sitting. Most provisions come into force on proclamation, anticipated September 1, 2026.

Requires classrooms to be 'neutral, impartial learning environments' and bars school boards from taking positions on political/ideological matters unrelated to education. Bans display of flags at schools other than the Alberta and Canada flags (with some exemptions) - capturing Pride and 'Every Child Matters' flags. Removes the requirement for ministerial approval of third-party materials on gender identity/sexual orientation/sexuality, extends the 2024 removal of 'sexually explicit' books, removes diversity references from the Education Act, and shields staff from activities conflicting with personal beliefs.

FOR

Government frames it as keeping 'politics and ideology' out of schools, protecting parental rights and viewpoint diversity, ensuring age-appropriate content, and protecting staff conscience. Supporters say schools should teach core skills, not advocacy.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Civil-liberties concern is high on free expression, equality (Charter s.2(b), s.15) and student inclusion rather than data privacy. Potential compelled-removal of materials and restraint on teacher/board speech. Data privacy proper: Minimal.

AGAINST

The CCLA calls it state censorship 'under the guise of neutrality,' warning it gives government broad power to define 'political/ideological' content and chills teaching and free expression. The ATA called it offensive to teachers; trustees fear it strips so much authority it could presage abolishing school boards. Removing identity flags (Pride, Every Child Matters) is seen as erasing belonging/safety markers for LGBTQ+ and Indigenous students; vague terms risk capturing health/SOGI resources.

WHO IT AFFECTS

K-12 students (especially LGBTQ+ and Indigenous students), teachers, school librarians, school boards/trustees, and parents across Alberta.

Bill 28 Municipal Affairs and Housing Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 (incl. Libraries Act changes) HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Dan Williams, Minister of Municipal Affairs (UCP) · Status: Received Royal Assent May 14, 2026. Omnibus bill amending the Municipal Government Act, Libraries Act and Housing Act; key details (incl. library content rules) to be set in regulations.

Two big thrusts. (1) Municipalities: expands the minister's power to make regulations, impose a universal councillor code of conduct, set transparency rules, and restrict how municipalities levy certain taxes/fees; includes an 'Automatic Yes' permitting concept. (2) Public libraries: lets the province restrict access to books deemed 'sexually explicit' for patrons 15 and under (kept behind counters/in separate areas, parental permission required) and empowers the minister to appoint inspectors to investigate library compliance across Alberta's ~324 public libraries.

FOR

Government frames municipal provisions as accountability, transparency and consistent 'ground rules,' and housing provisions as speeding approvals to address affordability. Library provisions framed as protecting children from age-inappropriate sexual content and empowering parents.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Civil-liberties risk is high on free expression / freedom to read and on local democratic accountability. Library inspection powers could touch patron records/access, and parental-permission gating may record who accesses restricted materials - a potential reader-privacy concern. Direct data-privacy impact: low-to-moderate; expression impact: high.

AGAINST

Municipal leaders warn of erosion of local democratic autonomy and sweeping ministerial control over locally elected councils. On libraries, NDP leader Nenshi called it 'fascist'; CCLA warns of a censorship 'slippery slope'; librarians say they were not consulted and that vague 'explicit' definitions could sweep in LGBTQ+ titles, health and educational resources. State inspectors policing library shelves raises freedom-of-expression and freedom-to-read concerns.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Library patrons (especially teens 15 and under and LGBTQ+ readers), librarians and library boards, municipal councils and councillors, and homebuilders/residents affected by housing-permit changes.

Bill 29 Health Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Minister of Health (UCP) · Status: Passed and received Royal Assent in the spring sitting; key provisions take effect later in 2026 with details in regulations (expected by fall 2026). Some provisions align terminology with not-yet-proclaimed 'dual practice' amendments from the prior Bill 11.

Amends the Alberta Health Care Insurance Act to let Albertans access certain private-pay preventative/diagnostic tests without a provider referral, and amends the Pharmacy and Drug Act to let authorized prescribers keep limited supplies of certain addiction-treatment medications for urgent situations. It is the latest step in Alberta's multi-year 'refocusing' and its move toward a dual-practice (mixed public-private) model.

FOR

Government and supporters argue it expands access, cuts wait times, lets patients pay for preventative screening they want, and adds capacity through private delivery; the addiction-medication change can speed urgent treatment.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Expanding private-pay testing and dual-practice billing raises questions about handling of health data by private providers and insurers and about equity of access. No new surveillance regime, but private-sector health data flows merit oversight. Privacy: low-to-moderate; equity/rights-to-care concern: high.

AGAINST

Health-policy critics (CCPA, the Tyee, health coalitions, legal experts on the related Bill 11) warn that allowing physicians to bill private patients for faster service entrenches two-tier care, contravenes Canada Health Act principles of accessibility/universality, can lengthen public-system waits, and lets income determine speed of care - potentially pressuring patients to pay or 'go to the back of the line.'

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Albertans relying on the public health system, lower-income patients (risk of unequal access), patients wanting private screening, people in addiction treatment, physicians, and the federal-provincial Canada Health Act transfer relationship.

Bill 26 Immigration Oversight Act WATCH

Sponsor: Minister of Immigration and Multiculturalism / Government (UCP) · Status: Introduced April 1, 2026; passed and received Royal Assent in the spring sitting. Licensing/registry requirements come into force on proclamation, with rules in regulations.

Creates a provincial oversight framework for the recruitment and hiring of foreign nationals: mandatory registry for employers accessing federal temporary-foreign-worker programs (including before obtaining an LMIA), a provincial licensing regime for foreign-worker recruiters and immigration consultants, and expanded provincial investigation/enforcement powers (fines, suspensions, licence revocation, bans, and in severe cases imprisonment via the courts). Targets fraud, paid-for job offers, unauthorized fees and exploitation.

FOR

Widely seen as largely protective of vulnerable migrant workers - it gives Alberta tools to hold exploitative recruiters and consultants accountable, curb labour trafficking and fraudulent job offers, and improve transparency where the province previously lacked authority.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Establishes a provincial registry of employers and licensing data on recruiters/consultants, plus investigative powers - meaning new government collection of employer and possibly worker-related data. Reasonable oversight purpose, but registry scope and data-sharing/retention bear watching. Privacy: moderate.

AGAINST

Concerns include added red tape/registration burden on legitimate employers and recruiters, provincial-federal jurisdictional overlap with the federal immigration-consultant regulator, and that aggressive enforcement could be used to tighten/control immigration broadly (the UCP is simultaneously pushing provincial immigration-control referendum questions). Effectiveness depends on yet-to-come regulations.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Temporary foreign workers and prospective immigrants (protective), employers using foreign workers, immigration consultants and foreign-worker recruiters operating in Alberta.

Bill 30 Expedited 120-Day Approvals Act, 2026 WATCH

Sponsor: Government of Alberta (UCP) - tabled by the minister responsible for major projects/Executive Council · Status: Tabled April 14, 2026; passed and received Royal Assent in the spring sitting. Comes into force on proclamation. (Official site confirms the bill; exact assent date not separately posted on the bill page at time of writing.)

Creates a fast-track stream for 'qualified' major projects (energy, mining, industrial) of at least \$250 million that fit provincial priorities. A new Project Coordination Review Team in Executive Council vets applications and recommends to a Deputy Ministers committee; Cabinet then issues an Order in Council triggering a 120-day approval clock for regulators (and for subsequent permits). Government says environmental assessment and Indigenous consultation must be 'sufficiently advanced' before a project enters the stream and that the Crown's s.35 duty to consult is unchanged.

FOR

Proponents and industry (and several law firms) say it cuts duplication and delay, improves coordination, and makes Alberta more competitive for major investment and jobs while, on paper, preserving environmental and Indigenous processes.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Primarily a process/approvals bill. Concern is concentration of executive power and reduced public/Indigenous input rather than personal data. Privacy: Minimal; democratic-accountability and Indigenous-rights concern: moderate.

AGAINST

Environmental groups (e.g. Environmental Law Centre) and legal commentators (ABLawg) warn the aggressive 120-day clock pressures regulators, risks rushed or lower-quality decisions, concentrates power in Cabinet/Executive Council, and could undercut public participation and the depth of Indigenous consultation despite assurances. Critics question whether 120 days is realistic for complex projects.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Large energy/mining/industrial proponents, provincial regulators (AER, AUC, etc.), Indigenous communities near projects, affected landowners, environmental organizations, and the public-participation process.

Bill 15 Public Safety and Emergency Services Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 (Alberta Sheriffs Police Service)

WATCH

Sponsor: Minister of Public Safety and Emergency Services (UCP) · Status: Received Royal Assent April 16, 2026. Implementation underway (transition of ~1,200 sheriff staff to the new Crown corporation).

Lays the legal groundwork to transition Alberta sheriffs into a new independent provincial police body, the Alberta Sheriffs Police Service (ASPS), structured as an arms-length Crown corporation. Provides a path for eligible sheriff peace officers to become full ASPS police officers (with additional training), moves ~1,200 staff and their budget, and affirms officers' right to form an association for collective bargaining.

FOR

Government frames it as a modern, accountable, made-in-Alberta police capability; protects affected employees' jobs and bargaining rights; supporters see faster, more locally responsive policing and a step toward provincial autonomy in law enforcement.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Stands up a new provincial policing entity with policing powers - surveillance, data collection and information-sharing implications depend on governance and oversight structures. Risk is medium and depends on accountability safeguards; no specific new surveillance program is created by the bill text itself.

AGAINST

Critics see it as building a de facto provincial police force (a long-running UCP goal) by another name, with questions about cost, duplication of the RCMP, oversight/accountability of a new Crown-corp police service, and political control over policing. Civil-liberties observers flag the importance of robust independent oversight for any expanded provincial policing.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Alberta sheriffs/peace officers and their unions, the public interacting with provincial law enforcement, municipalities and RCMP-policed communities, and provincial-federal policing arrangements.

Bill 1 International Agreements Act WATCH

Sponsor: Government of Alberta (UCP) - Premier Danielle Smith's priority bill · Status: Introduced as the fall-2025 priority bill of this 2nd Session and passed; in force. Defines the session's 'provincial sovereignty' theme alongside the planned October 2026 referendum.

Modeled partly on Quebec's framework, it requires Alberta's approval before a federal international agreement affecting areas of provincial jurisdiction can take effect within the province. It is a sovereignty/jurisdiction-assertion measure tied to the UCP's broader autonomy agenda (and the fall 2026 referendum with constitutional and immigration questions).

FOR

Government argues it protects provincial jurisdiction from federal overreach via international deals, mirrors an existing Quebec approach, and gives Alberta a formal say where federal treaties touch provincial powers.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

No direct personal-data or surveillance impact. Concern is federalism, the rule of law, and Indigenous treaty relationships rather than privacy. Privacy: Minimal.

AGAINST

Critics call it constitutionally dubious and largely symbolic (foreign affairs/treaty-making is federal), a distraction from labour and affordability issues, and part of a separatist-adjacent agenda. Treaty First Nations (Treaties 6, 7, 8) have strongly objected to the UCP's sovereignty/resource agenda - the Assembly of Treaty Chiefs passed a historic non-confidence vote in the government in early 2026.

WHO IT AFFECTS

The Alberta-Ottawa relationship, businesses and sectors touched by international/trade agreements (e.g. CUSMA review), Indigenous nations with treaty rights, and Albertans generally via the sovereignty/referendum agenda.

Bill 31 Red Tape Reduction Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 (ends seasonal clock changes) LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Minister responsible for Red Tape Reduction (UCP) · Status: Passed first reading April 23, 2026, and proceeded through the spring sitting as part of the 17-bill suite; an omnibus red-tape bill. Provisions take effect on proclamation. (Confirm exact final stage on assembly.ab.ca if precision is needed.)

An omnibus 'red tape' bill amending multiple statutes to cut regulatory requirements; its most public element is ending the twice-yearly daylight-saving time clock change (moving Alberta to a permanent time), plus assorted administrative streamlining across government.

FOR

Framed as reducing administrative burden on businesses and citizens; the permanent-time element is broadly popular with people who dislike clock changes and cite health/safety benefits of stopping the switch.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. No meaningful privacy or civil-liberties dimension beyond the general transparency concern with omnibus drafting.

AGAINST

Omnibus red-tape bills bundle many unrelated changes, reducing scrutiny of individual amendments; 'efficiency' deregulation can quietly weaken protections. The time-change element's practical effect depends on coordination with neighbouring jurisdictions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Albertans (time change), and businesses/individuals affected by the various deregulated administrative requirements.

Legislative Assembly of Manitoba (57 seats)

Session: 43rd Legislature, 3rd Session — runs November 18, 2025 to a scheduled end of November 5, 2026. Currently sitting (Order Paper No. 64 dated June 1, 2026). The spring portion of the sitting saw a large batch of government bills receive Royal Assent on June 1, 2026; the House resumed/continued with new bills introduced that same day.

Government: New Democratic Party (NDP) MAJORITY government. Premier: Wab Kinew (in office since Oct 18, 2023; first First Nations premier of a Canadian province). Standings: NDP 34, Progressive Conservatives 22, Liberal 1 (29 needed for majority). Speaker: Tom Lindsey (NDP). Opposition Leader: Obby Khan (PC).

SOURCING: Statutes are taken from the authoritative official "Status of Bills, Third Session, Forty-Third Legislature"

(gov.mb.ca/legislature/business/billstatus.pdf, last updated June 1, 2026) and the June 1, 2026 Order Paper. Analysis/criticism is drawn from CBC, Globe and Mail, CP24/CTV, privacy-law scholar Teresa Scassa, the Manitoba Eco-Network, the Right to Housing Coalition, the Canadian Property Tax Association, the Canadian Centre for Policy Alternatives, and Manitoba government news releases. CONTEXT: This is a long single session (Nov 2025–Nov 2026) rather than two sessions; the government did NOT prorogue between the fall and spring sittings, so bills carried over. On June 1, 2026 the bulk of the government's legislative program (40+ bills) received Royal Assent in one evening — a normal end-of-sitting pattern in Manitoba. Several bills are marked "P" (passed but awaiting proclamation to come into force) versus "RA" (in force on Royal Assent). STILL IN PROGRESS / NOT YET PASSED as of June 1, 2026: Bill 13 Residential Tenancies (only 2nd reading), Bill 21 Drinking Water Safety (1st reading), Bill 47 Apprenticeship and Certification (1st reading), Bill 54 Smoking and Vapour Products Control (1st reading), and a fresh slate introduced June 1 at first reading — Bill 7 (Health System Governance), Bill 12 (Crown-Indigenous Corporation), Bill 22 (Child & Family Services – Indigenous Jurisdiction), Bill 24 (Public Health), Bill 25 (Fisheries/Forest/Wildlife), Bill 55 (Budget Implementation #2), Bill 56 (Liquor/Gaming/Cannabis), Bill 57 (Livestock). BUDGET CONTEXT: Budget 2026 (implemented by Bill 53) projects a ~\$498-million deficit with a promise to balance by the 2027 election. Moody's and other critics call the balance plan inconsistent with the government's own growth projections; the prior year's deficit ballooned to ~\$1.6–1.7 billion, which the government attributes largely to a record 2025 wildfire season. The Canadian Federation of Independent Business/Fraser-style scorecards graded the finance minister poorly (D-). OVERALL CIVIL-LIBERTIES READ: This session is largely rights-positive or rights-neutral (intimate-image/deepfake protections, a notwithstanding-clause safeguard, expanded rent control, sick-note relief, nurse ratios, Indigenous child-welfare jurisdiction, anti-algorithmic-pricing consumer protection). The clearest privacy/civil-liberties watch-items are Bill 51 (public-sector AI governance left almost entirely to future regulations) and the weapons-control bills (Bills 8/9), which create warrantless inspection powers for retailers and ID-collection at point of sale, with potential enforcement/profiling concerns.

Bill 4 The Constitutional Questions Amendment Act (notwithstanding-clause safeguard)

RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Matt Wiebe, Minister of Justice (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law (in force on assent).

Requires the provincial Cabinet, before a Manitoba law can rely on section 33 of the Charter (the 'notwithstanding clause' that lets governments override certain Charter rights), to first refer the matter to the Manitoba Court of Appeal for an opinion on its merits. It adds a mandatory public/judicial-scrutiny step; it does not ban using the clause.

FOR

Framed as a guardrail against governments (as in Quebec, Saskatchewan, Alberta) using the clause pre-emptively to override rights of minorities, including religious minorities and 2SLGBTQ+ people. Forces transparency and 'robust public discussion' before rights are suspended. Supported by the government and rights advocates as a democratic-accountability measure.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal direct privacy impact. Civil-liberties relevant in the rights-protective sense: it is designed to make it harder/more visible to strip Charter rights, but provides no hard legal barrier.

AGAINST

Largely symbolic: the Court of Appeal's opinion is non-binding and cannot stop the government from proceeding. Constitutionally, one legislature cannot bind a future one, so a later government could simply repeal or ignore this Act in the same bill that invokes section 33 — echoing scholars' 'paper tiger' description of the clause. Critics call it political signalling more than an enforceable limit.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Manitobans, especially minority and equality-seeking groups whose rights could be targeted by a future government's use of the notwithstanding clause.

Bill 2 The Non-Consensual Distribution of Intimate Images Amendment Act (deepfakes)

RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Matt Wiebe, Minister of Justice (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law.

Modernizes Manitoba's intimate-image law for the AI era. Expands 'intimate image' to include 'nearly nude' images and images where the person isn't identifiable; adds 'fake intimate image' to cover deepfakes that falsely depict an identifiable person sexually. Creates civil liability for merely threatening to distribute such images, lets courts order platforms/search engines to remove and de-index images on timelines, and limits the 'public interest' defence.

FOR

Closes a major gap on AI-generated sexual deepfakes and sextortion threats; gives victims faster takedown and de-indexing remedies; requires courts to weigh the victim's wishes on publication bans. Widely viewed as a strong, victim-centred update. Privacy-law scholar Teresa Scassa highlighted the expanded definitions and new threat-based tort as notable improvements.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Strongly privacy-protective for victims of image-based abuse and deepfakes — expands control over one's own intimate/sexual likeness and creates removal rights. Minimal downside privacy risk.

AGAINST

Enforcement against offshore platforms and anonymous distributors remains hard; the 'reasonable steps' safe harbour for internet intermediaries may limit platform accountability. Some free-expression observers watch the broadened definitions (e.g. 'nearly nude,' non-identifiable subjects) for overreach, though the public-interest and law-enforcement carve-outs temper this.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Victims of revenge porn, sextortion and AI deepfakes (disproportionately women and youth); online platforms and search engines now subject to removal/de-indexing orders.

Bills 8 & 9 Long-Bladed Weapon Control Amendment Act (machetes) & The Street Weapons Control Act

WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Matt Wiebe, Minister of Justice (NDP) · Status: Both received Royal Assent June 1, 2026; marked 'P' — passed but awaiting proclamation to take effect.

Bill 8 tightens sales rules for long-bladed weapons (machetes/knives/swords with a blade ~30 cm+): secure storage, no sales to under-18s, photo-ID and record-keeping by retailers. Bill 9 creates a new framework to restrict carrying/sale of designated 'street weapons' (e.g. machetes, bear spray) in public places, while exempting use/possession on one's own private property. Enforced by inspectors from the Public Safety Investigations Unit.

FOR

Responds to a rise in machete-involved violence; targets retail supply rather than criminalizing ordinary tool use; keeps farm/rural and home uses legal. Government says regulations bar copying of photo ID to protect buyer privacy. Backed as a public-safety measure developed with law enforcement, retailers and Indigenous leadership.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium. Mandatory photo-ID collection at point of sale and retailer record-keeping create new personal-data trails (mitigated by a rule against copying ID). Inspectors get warrantless entry to business premises (not private dwellings without consent or a warrant). Public-carry enforcement raises search-and-profiling questions.

AGAINST

Critics call it largely symbolic — an 18-year-old can still legally buy and distribute machetes, and knives are a means, not the cause, of violence; underlying drivers (poverty, gang involvement, conditions on remote reserves) go unaddressed. Civil-liberties concern that broad public-carry bans plus discretionary enforcement could lead to disproportionate stops/searches of racialized and Indigenous youth.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Retailers of bladed/defensive weapons; buyers (now ID'd); the general public in parks/public spaces; potential disproportionate impact on Indigenous and racialized young people through enforcement.

Bill 11 The Employment Standards Code Amendment Act (Sick Notes)

RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Malaya Marcelino, Minister of Labour and Immigration (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law.

Bars most employers from requiring a doctor's sick note for short-term/minor employee absences, so workers don't have to pay for and obtain medical documentation (and tie up clinics) for a few sick days.

FOR

Reduces unnecessary burden on workers and on the health system; keeps sick, contagious employees out of workplaces; aligns with similar moves in other provinces. Popular with labour, workers and physicians' groups who say sick notes for minor illness waste medical time.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Privacy-positive: less compelled disclosure of personal medical information to employers for routine short absences.

AGAINST

Some employer/business groups worry about absenteeism abuse and lost productivity without verification. Effect is bounded by how many paid sick days workers actually have under Manitoba standards.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Most Manitoba employees and their employers; family doctors and walk-in clinics (reduced administrative demand).

Bill 13 The Residential Tenancies Amendment Act (rent-control expansion) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Mintu Sandhu, Minister of Public Service Delivery (NDP) · Status: IN PROGRESS — second reading completed April 13, 2026; had NOT cleared committee, third reading or Royal Assent as of June 1, 2026. Status to be confirmed on the official site.

Described by the minister as the 'largest expansion to rent controls in decades.' Raises the rent-control exemption threshold from \$1,670 to \$2,000/month (bringing thousands more units under control) and cuts in half the share of renovation/capital costs a landlord can pass on through above-guideline rent increases (e.g. only \$50,000 of a \$100,000 project claimable). The 2026 guideline increase is 1.8%.

FOR

Tenant and anti-poverty groups (e.g. the Right to Housing Coalition, CCPA) welcome broader coverage and limits on large 'above-guideline' hikes, which they say have driven steep, made-in-Manitoba rent increases. Aims at affordability and housing stability for the hundreds of thousands of Manitobans who rent.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy/civil-liberties implications.

AGAINST

Landlord/property groups (e.g. Canadian Property Tax Association) argue halving claimable capital costs makes major repairs uneconomic — projecting negative returns on typical older buildings, deferred maintenance in lower-rent stock, ~\$353M/yr in lost renovation work, and reduced new investment, potentially worsening supply and undercutting Winnipeg's federal housing-growth targets. Tenant advocates, conversely, say it still needs strengthening.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Renters (more units protected, smaller increases) and landlords/building owners (reduced cost recovery); the broader rental-housing market and trades that do building renovations.

Bill 49 The Business Practices Amendment Act (algorithmic / personalized pricing) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Mintu Sandhu, Minister of Public Service Delivery (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026; marked 'P' — passed, awaiting proclamation.

Regulates 'personalized algorithmic pricing' — using algorithms and large-scale personal-data collection (behaviour, demographics, location, financial status) to charge a specific consumer more. Prohibits online retailers/distributors from using algorithmic pricing to raise prices, bans surprise higher prices via electronic shelf labels without clear consumer consent, requires prominent disclosure of price and fees, and gives consumers access to the data used about them.

FOR

An early, notable Canadian move against opaque 'surveillance pricing.' Privacy scholar Teresa Scassa flags that algorithmic price discrimination is normally invisible to consumers, so a ban plus a data-access right is a meaningful consumer-privacy protection. Frames covert data-driven price discrimination as an unfair business practice.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Strongly privacy-positive: directly targets exploitation of personal data for individualized pricing and creates a consumer right to see the data used to price them. Among the most pro-privacy measures of the session.

AGAINST

Enforceability is uncertain — detecting hidden algorithmic pricing is difficult, and definitions/consent mechanics may be hard to police. Scope (provincial, consumer-goods focused) limits reach; effectiveness depends on how aggressively it is enforced and on forthcoming details.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Manitoba consumers (especially online shoppers); online retailers, distributors and any business deploying dynamic/personalized pricing or electronic shelf labels.

Bill 51 The Public Sector Artificial Intelligence and Cybersecurity Governance Act WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Mike Moroz, Minister responsible (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026; marked 'P' — passed, awaiting proclamation; core obligations depend on regulations not yet made.

Creates an enabling ('plug-and-play') framework letting government set rules by regulation for how public-sector bodies (government, agencies, health authorities, universities, school divisions, municipalities) use AI systems and handle cybersecurity. The statute itself is largely a shell: the substantive duties (risk/impact assessments, accountability frameworks) are to be filled in later by Cabinet regulations.

FOR

First-of-its-kind provincial framework for public-sector AI; flexible and updatable without re-opening the statute (modelled on Ontario's 2024 law). Signals intent to require risk/impact assessments and accountability for government AI use, plus cybersecurity standards across the broader public sector.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium and contingent. Potentially privacy-protective IF strong regulations mandate transparency, impact assessments and limits on government AI/automated decision-making affecting residents; but as enacted it provides no concrete safeguards, oversight body, or individual rights — so the privacy/civil-liberties payoff is deferred and uncertain.

AGAINST

Privacy scholar Teresa Scassa warns that without regulations it is 'nothing more than words on a page,' noting Ontario's comparable 2025 law produced no public-sector AI rules a year on — risking an 'empty policy placeholder.' The Manitoba Eco-Network and others criticize: no environmental-impact requirement for AI/data-centre energy and water use, heavy use of discretionary 'may,' no mandatory accountability elements, and that it advanced before the province's public AI consultation even began — shifting key rules to closed-door Cabinet decisions.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone interacting with Manitoba public services where AI/automated decisions may be used (health, education, social services, municipal services); public-sector bodies that must eventually comply; the AI/data-centre industry.

Bill 53 The Budget Implementation and Tax Statutes Amendment Act, 2026 (PST off groceries) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Adrien Sala, Minister of Finance (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law; the grocery PST cut takes effect July 1, 2026.

Implements Budget 2026. Headline measure removes the 7% provincial sales tax from all food and beverages sold at grocery/food stores starting July 1, 2026 (including previously-taxed items like rotisserie chicken, sandwiches and samosas). Also enacts various tax and fiscal changes; budget projects a ~\$498M deficit with a stated goal of balancing before the 2027 election.

FOR

Direct cost-of-living relief — government estimates ~\$24M in consumer savings; broadly popular with shoppers and welcomed by the Retail Council of Canada. Pairs with health-care spending increases. Universal and simple at the till.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy/civil-liberties implications.

AGAINST

Costs the treasury ~\$32M/yr and is untargeted (benefits high earners too). Credit-rating agency Moody's and analysts say the plan to balance the budget is inconsistent with the government's own growth forecasts; the prior-year deficit ballooned toward ~\$1.6–1.7B (government blames the 2025 wildfire season). The finance minister drew poor marks (D-) on a national fiscal-performance scorecard. Opposition frames it as spending beyond the province's means.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Manitoba grocery shoppers (tax relief from July 1, 2026); provincial finances and the broader debate over the deficit/balanced-budget timeline.

Bill 28 The Health System Governance and Accountability Amendment Act (Nurse-to-Patient Ratios) RIGHTS-

POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Uzoma Asagwara, Deputy Premier & Minister of Health, Seniors and Long-Term Care (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026; marked 'P' — passed, awaiting proclamation. (Companion Bill 26 ending mandatory nurse overtime, and Bill 27 a patient bill of rights, were also passed.)

Enables enforceable minimum nurse-to-patient staffing ratios in the health system, part of an NDP package that also ends mandatory overtime for nurses (Bill 26) and declares principles for patient care (Bill 27). Aims to improve safety and retention by capping how many patients a nurse must cover.

FOR

Backed by nurses' unions and patient-safety advocates; addresses burnout, mandatory overtime and understaffing widely blamed for ER and care problems. Could improve care quality and help retain front-line staff.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy/civil-liberties implications (health-system staffing measure).

AGAINST

Effectiveness hinges on regulations setting the actual ratios and on whether enough nurses exist to meet them amid shortages — critics question feasibility and cost, and warn ratios without recruitment could force bed closures or simply shift strain. Marked 'P,' so timing/teeth depend on proclamation and regulations.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Nurses and front-line health workers; hospital and long-term-care patients; regional health authorities and the provincial health budget.

Bill 36 The Child and Family Services Amendment Act (Indigenous jurisdiction) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Nahanni Fontaine, Minister of Families (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law. (A further Bill 22, Child and Family Services Amendment Act (Indigenous Jurisdiction), was newly introduced at first reading on June 1, 2026 to build on this.)

Supports the transfer of child-welfare authority to Indigenous Governing Bodies and Service Providers: gives them access to information about the children/families they serve, authorizes administrative transfer of service responsibility, lets them use the provincial CFS electronic information system and Child Abuse Registry, and protects shared information. Includes a 'no gap in services' rule so jurisdictional disputes can't leave Indigenous children without care.

FOR

Advances self-government and the Truth and Reconciliation Commission's Calls to Action; aligns provincial law with Indigenous jurisdiction over child welfare and aims for substantive equality for Indigenous children, who are vastly over-represented in care in Manitoba. Generally welcomed by Indigenous child-welfare authorities.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Mixed but on balance positive/neutral: extends access to sensitive child-welfare records (including the Child Abuse Registry) and the provincial CFS data system to Indigenous bodies — appropriate for those exercising jurisdiction, with explicit information-protection provisions, but it does widen who can access highly sensitive family data, so safeguards and governance matter.

AGAINST

Implementation, funding and the practical mechanics of data-sharing and transfer are complex; success depends on resourcing and on resolving overlaps with the federal Indigenous child-welfare framework. Some advocates will watch whether transfers are adequately funded and truly Indigenous-led.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Indigenous children, families and communities; Indigenous Governing Bodies/Service Providers taking over child welfare; the provincial CFS system.

Bill 40 The Elections Amendment Act (candidate ethics disclosure) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Matt Wiebe, Minister of Justice (NDP) · Status: Royal Assent June 1, 2026 — now law (applies to subsequent elections, with no 90-day delay).

Adds an election-disclosure rule for candidates who are or were MLAs: they must disclose if the Ethics Commissioner found they contravened the conflict-of-interest law in a case where the Assembly imposed a fine, suspended their voting rights, or declared their seat vacant. A mere reprimand does not trigger disclosure.

FOR

Improves democratic accountability and voter information by surfacing serious, formally-sanctioned conflict-of-interest findings before people vote. Proportionate — excludes minor matters resolved by reprimand.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal/positive: discloses official, already-adjudicated public ethics findings, not private personal data.

AGAINST

Narrow in scope (only former/sitting MLAs, only the most serious sanctioned findings); critics could argue it doesn't capture broader ethics issues or non-MLA candidates. Low controversy overall.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Candidates who are or were MLAs; voters seeking information about candidates' ethics records.

Bill 12 The Manitoba Crown-Indigenous Corporation Act (Port of Churchill / Churchill Plus) LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Ian Bushie, Minister responsible (NDP) · Status: IN PROGRESS — introduced at first reading on June 1, 2026; early stage, not yet passed. Status to be confirmed on the official site.

Establishes a Crown-Indigenous corporation (described as a first-of-its-kind partnership) to lead major trade-corridor projects, especially expansion of the Port of Churchill and the 'Churchill Plus' initiative, with Indigenous leadership central to governance and decision-making. Aimed at positioning Manitoba's northern port as a trade gateway (e.g. for agricultural exports) and rail-line improvements.

FOR

Embeds Indigenous co-governance and benefit-sharing in northern economic development; pursues nation-building trade infrastructure, jobs and a diversified export route; developed with the Assembly of Manitoba Chiefs, Manitoba Métis Federation and First Nations leadership; pledges environmental stewardship informed by Indigenous knowledge.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal privacy/civil-liberties implications.

AGAINST

Big-ticket infrastructure with execution, financing and viability risk (the Churchill rail/port has a troubled history); critics note Churchill's absence from the first wave of federal 'nation-building' projects. Governance structure of a new Crown-Indigenous entity will need scrutiny for accountability and transparency.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Northern and Indigenous communities (especially around Churchill); Manitoba exporters/agriculture; provincial taxpayers funding the corporation; the broader trade-corridor economy.

Legislative Assembly of Saskatchewan

Session: 30th Legislature, 2nd Session. Sat from October 28, 2025 and adjourned May 14, 2026; scheduled to reconvene October 27, 2026 (fall sitting). The legislature was elected October 28, 2024; the 1st Session ran November 2024 to spring 2025.

Government: Saskatchewan Party majority government (34 of 61 seats), Premier Scott Moe. Official Opposition: Saskatchewan NDP (27 seats), leader Carla Beck. Note: during the 2nd Session, MLA Betty Nippi-Albright (Saskatoon Centre) left the NDP caucus to sit as an Independent over the party's handling of the involuntary-treatment debate, marginally shifting the opposition benches.

SOURCING AND CONFIDENCE: Bill numbers and statuses are taken from the official "Progress of Bills, 30th Legislature, 2nd Session" document dated May 14, 2026 (legassembly.sk.ca) - high confidence. Government composition KEY CONTEXT: This list is dominated by GOVERNMENT bills that passed and received Royal Assent on May 14, 2026 - many "come into force" later by proclamation/Order in Council, so they are LAW but several are not yet operational (notably Bill 48, the involuntary-treatment law, expected fall 2026). The included PRIVATE MEMBERS' bills (Bills 608, 611, 628) are NDP OPPOSITION bills that did NOT pass - in a Sask Party majority they died on the order paper - but they are the most consequential rights/affordability-relevant items the opposition advanced and are included to show the policy debate. CAVEATS / UNVERIFIED ITEMS: (1) Whether the new Defamation Act (Bill 31) contains strong anti-SLAPP free-expression protections could NOT be confirmed from available reporting - the Law Reform Commission recommended them, but inclusion is unverified; this materially affects its civil-liberties rating. (2) Detailed text of the late-tabled NDP transparency bills (628 and the related lobbyist/conflict-of-interest bills) was not debated, so their specific provisions are unverified. (3) The Compassionate Intervention Act's exact detention/assessment durations and review safeguards are largely in regulations not yet public. OTHER NOTABLE BILLS NOT BROKEN OUT (lower civil-liberties relevance): Bill 24 Saskatchewan Internal Trade Promotion Act (interprovincial trade barriers - passed); Bill 49 Income Tax Amendment Act, 2026 and the budget appropriation bills (cost-of-living/fiscal - passed; the 2025-26 budget was framed around a deficit and health-care spending); Bill 43 Municipalities Modernization and Red Tape Reduction Act (passed); Bill 35 Mineral Resources Amendment Act and Bill 53 Chemical Fertilizer Incentive Amendment (resource/agriculture - passed); Bill 58/59 The Time Act (potential move to year-round time - passed). Several additional NDP PMBs targeted health-care transparency (ER-closure right-to-know, banning private fees, cancer-patient parking fees) and affordability (Bill 612 Lower Power Bills and Car Insurance; Bill 620 grocery property controls) - all died on the order paper. Privacy/surveillance-specific legislation was relatively thin this session; the strongest civil-liberties flashpoint by far is Bill 48 (involuntary treatment), with Bills 47, 54 and 31 as secondary concerns.

Bill 48 The Compassionate Intervention Act HIGH CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Lori Carr (Minister of Mental Health and Addictions), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026 - law, but comes into force on proclamation (Order in Council); government says expected to be operational in fall 2026 once regulations are finalized. First assessment centre and involuntary inpatient unit at Saskatchewan Hospital North Battleford.

Creates a legal framework for involuntary (forced) treatment of people with severe substance addiction. A person can be brought to a Compassionate Intervention Assessment Centre by police/peace officer, on referral from a prescribed medical professional, or by a judge's warrant (which family members can apply for). If a person's substance use is found to put their own life or others' lives at serious risk and they are deemed unable to make an informed decision, they can be detained and treated against their will.

FOR

Government and supporters argue it is a compassionate last-resort tool to save lives amid a deadly drug-poisoning crisis, gives desperate families a legal avenue to get a loved one help, and pairs with a record \$624M for mental-health and addictions services. Backed by some families of people with addiction.

AGAINST

The Saskatchewan Medical Association and College of Physicians and Surgeons jointly opposed it, saying involuntary addiction treatment is not supported by clinical evidence and may increase overdose death risk after release; that the health system lacks capacity to implement it safely (ERs already overstretched); and that clinical definitions, eligibility criteria and validated assessment tools are missing. The John Howard Society and others warn voluntary care is underfunded. NDP opposed it; the dispute split the NDP caucus.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People with severe substance-use disorders (especially the most marginalized and unhoused), their families, police, physicians and front-line health workers, and the broader harm-reduction and addictions-treatment system.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Significant civil-liberties concern: authorizes state detention and forced medical treatment of people who have committed no crime, engaging Charter s.7 (life, liberty, security of the person) and s.9 (arbitrary detention). Legal experts expect a Charter challenge (as anticipated for Alberta's near-identical law). Involves collection and sharing of sensitive health/addiction data and police involvement in a medical process; safeguards on detention length, review, and data handling are largely left to regulations not yet public.

Bill 47 The Response to Illicit Drugs Act WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Tim McLeod (Minister of Justice / Attorney General), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026; came into force June 1, 2026 - now in effect.

Creates a statutory civil cause of action letting the Government of Saskatchewan, and individuals harmed by illicit drug activity, sue people involved in producing, trafficking, importing or exporting highly addictive (Schedule I) drugs to recover costs and damages. Also lets the government void certain appointments, grants, or agreements with anyone convicted of specified Schedule I drug offences. The civil action targets major trafficking operations and does not apply to simple possession.

FOR

Framed as holding drug traffickers financially accountable for harm to communities and the health system, and recovering public costs. Lower civil standard of proof (balance of probabilities) lets the province pursue traffickers even without a criminal conviction. Carve-out for simple possession blunts the 'criminalizing users' critique.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium. A civil-litigation tool operating below the criminal burden of proof can expose people to asset seizure and reputational/financial harm without a criminal conviction, and may rely on investigative/financial data. Less intrusive than involuntary detention, but due-process and proportionality concerns remain.

AGAINST

Critics question practical effectiveness (recovering money from traffickers is hard) and warn civil 'cost-recovery' tools that bypass the criminal standard of proof can be over-broad. Drug-policy advocates argue enforcement-and-punishment approaches do little to reduce overdose deaths versus treatment and harm reduction. Risk that broadly drafted provisions sweep in peripheral actors.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People involved in (or alleged to be involved in) drug production/trafficking, anyone holding government appointments or contracts, and indirectly communities affected by the drug supply.

Bill 34 The Cyberstalking and Coercive Control Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Tim McLeod (Minister of Justice / Attorney General), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent December 4, 2025; in force (Assent) - now law and operative.

Expands the definition of 'interpersonal violence' under The Victims of Interpersonal Violence Act to add coercive and controlling behaviour (e.g., depriving someone of basic needs, closely monitoring their activities, isolating them from family and friends) and cyberstalking/online harassment (reported to include image-based abuse and pornographic deepfakes). This widens access to civil protections such as emergency intervention/restraining orders and the ability to end a long-term tenancy where future violence is a risk.

FOR

Widely supported by anti-violence advocates (e.g., PATHS) for recognizing non-physical and digital abuse that the law previously missed, helping victims of domestic abuse obtain protection orders and housing relief earlier. Modernizes the law for online and AI-enabled harms (deepfakes).

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Positive for civil liberties on balance: strengthens protection against image-based sexual abuse, deepfakes, and digital surveillance/stalking by abusers, which are themselves serious privacy violations. Minor consideration: broad behavioural definitions in any restraining-order regime require careful, evidence-based application to avoid misuse, but this is a civil-protection (not criminal) framework.

AGAINST

Criticisms are mostly about adequacy and resourcing rather than the concept: advocates note protection orders only help if survivors have shelter, legal aid, and police follow-through, which require funding. 'Coercive control' is inherently hard to define and prove, raising questions about consistent application.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Survivors of domestic and interpersonal violence (disproportionately women), victims of online harassment and deepfake abuse, alleged abusers subject to protection orders, courts, and police.

Bill 42 The Saskatchewan Firearms Amendment Act, 2025 LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Tim McLeod (Minister of Justice / Attorney General; Minister responsible for the Saskatchewan Firearms Office), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent March 12, 2026; in force by Order in Council - now law and operative.

A provincial pushback against the federal firearms buyback. Requires that anyone (i.e., the federal government) who 'seizes' a firearm under federal law must pay the owner fair market value as set by the Saskatchewan Firearms Commissioner; firearms are deemed 'seized' if affected by a federal ban and the owner is not fairly compensated within 12 months. Sets up an online appraisal portal for affected firearms/ammunition/accessories (to create court evidence), and (via a late amendment) allows exemption certificates for affected lawful owners.

FOR

Supported by firearms-owner groups (e.g., CSSA) and the government as protecting law-abiding Saskatchewan gun owners' property rights and ensuring fair compensation. Politically popular in much of rural Saskatchewan.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low / mostly property-rights rather than privacy. The appraisal portal collects firearm-ownership data provincially, which has some data-handling implications, but it is largely a property-compensation and federal-provincial-jurisdiction measure rather than a surveillance one.

AGAINST

Gun-control advocates argue it is a constitutionally questionable attempt to frustrate a valid federal public-safety program (firearms are federal jurisdiction), risks intergovernmental conflict and litigation, and could create administrative gridlock around the buyback. Effectiveness depends on whether provincial appraisal/exemption mechanisms can lawfully bind Ottawa.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Licensed firearms owners in Saskatchewan whose guns are caught by federal prohibitions, the federal buyback program, and the provincial Firearms Office.

Bill 38 The Building Schools Faster Act (with consequential Bill 39) LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Everett Hindley (Minister of Education), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026 - law; comes into force on proclamation (Order in Council).

Aims to speed up school construction in fast-growing neighbourhoods by making municipalities responsible for acquiring serviced land for new schools and committing the province to a cost-sharing formula. Amends The Planning and Development Act, 2007 to give municipalities new tools, including a 'school land development fee' charged to developers and the ability to increase municipal reserve land by an extra 2%. Applies to new development areas, not existing-site redevelopment.

FOR

Government argues it removes a key bottleneck (securing land) so schools open sooner in booming areas, with predictable provincial-municipal cost sharing.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. This is land-use, municipal-finance and education-infrastructure legislation with no significant privacy or surveillance dimension.

AGAINST

The Saskatchewan Urban Municipalities Association complained of poor engagement and lack of transparency. Home-builder associations in Saskatoon and Regina estimate the new fees/reserve requirements will add roughly \$8,000 to the cost of every new home, worsening housing affordability. Regina school divisions said the bill alone won't actually build schools faster without funding for construction itself.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Families in growing communities, municipalities, land developers and (via passed-through fees) home buyers, and school divisions.

Bill 54 The Correctional Services Amendment Act, 2026 WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Michael Weger (Minister of Corrections, Policing and Public Safety / Community Safety), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026 - law; comes into force on proclamation (Order in Council).

Modernizes the provincial corrections law. Introduces a more structured, independent inmate-discipline process in which serious disciplinary matters are decided by Justices of the Peace, and creates a partnership with the new Saskatchewan Marshals Service to investigate criminal offences committed inside provincial correctional facilities. Sits alongside the province's testing of drone-detection technology to stop contraband (drugs, weapons, phones) smuggled into prisons.

FOR

Government says it improves safety, fairness and consistency and adds independent oversight (JPs deciding serious discipline) for both inmates and staff. Independent adjudication of discipline can be a procedural-fairness improvement over purely internal decisions.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium. Expanded investigative powers inside correctional facilities and drone-detection/surveillance technology around prisons raise surveillance and data-collection considerations for inmates, visitors, and people living near facilities. Independent adjudication is a due-process plus; the surveillance footprint is the watch-point.

AGAINST

Prisoner-rights and civil-liberties observers will watch how 'stronger consequences' and expanded investigative powers (including by the Marshals Service) are used, and whether independent-discipline promises are matched by real access to representation and appeal. Effectiveness of drone interdiction and surveillance around facilities is unproven.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People held in provincial custody, correctional staff, the Saskatchewan Marshals Service, and communities/airspace near correctional facilities.

Bill 31 The Defamation Act (with consequential Bill 32) WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Tim McLeod (Minister of Justice / Attorney General), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026 - law; comes into force on proclamation (Order in Council). Reported with amendment by the Intergovernmental Affairs and Justice Committee in April 2026.

Replaces the 1909 Libel and Slander Act. Abolishes the libel/slander distinction (everything is now 'defamation'), adapts the law to digital/online communication, lets courts order removal or de-indexing of harmful online content that keeps circulating, and adopts a 'single publication' rule so an original post and later re-publications by the same publisher are one cause of action (which generally helps publishers by limiting repeat liability and clarifying limitation periods).

FOR

Modernizes badly outdated law for the internet era; the single-publication rule reduces open-ended liability for online content; court-ordered de-indexing gives genuine victims of defamation an enforceable remedy. Based on a 2024 Law Reform Commission of Saskatchewan report.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium, free-expression dimension. Powers to order removal/de-indexing of online content touch directly on freedom of expression and the public's access to information; the safeguard against abuse is strong anti-SLAPP and a high threshold for takedowns, which is exactly the point experts say must be verified. On the positive side, it gives recourse against genuinely defamatory online material.

AGAINST

A key concern is whether the Act includes robust anti-SLAPP (anti-Strategic-Lawsuit-Against-Public-Participation) protections, which the Law Reform Commission recommended; available reporting does not clearly confirm strong anti-SLAPP provisions were included (UNVERIFIED). Without them, well-resourced plaintiffs can still use defamation suits to silence journalists, critics and ordinary citizens. Court-ordered content removal/de-indexing also raises free-expression questions about who decides what is 'harmful.'

WHO IT AFFECTS

Journalists and news outlets, online publishers and platforms, people defamed online, and anyone who comments publicly (potential SLAPP targets).

Bill 57 The Information Services Corporation Amendment Act, 2026 LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Jeremy Harrison (Minister responsible for ISC / Crown Investments), Sask Party · Status: Royal Assent May 14, 2026 - law; comes into force on proclamation (Order in Council). Enacted amid a takeover bid for ISC.

Strengthens the government's 'golden share' control over Information Services Corporation (ISC) as a private buyer pursues the company. Requires that ISC's intellectual property - registry technology, software and data management - and its data stay in Saskatchewan, keeps ISC as the exclusive operator of the Land Registry, Personal Property Registry, Land Surveys Directory and Corporate Registry, keeps the head office/jobs in-province, and lifts the share-ownership cap (enabling the sale while preserving controls).

FOR

Government frames it as protecting residents' interests and keeping sensitive provincial land/personal-property/corporate registry data and the head office in Saskatchewan even after a change of ownership. Province expects roughly \$277M from selling its shares, earmarked for health-care infrastructure.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low-to-watch. ISC holds sensitive personal and property data (land titles, personal-property security, corporate records). The data-residency ('stay in Saskatchewan') requirement is privacy-protective, but ongoing private control of essential public registries warrants attention to access, security and oversight of that data.

AGAINST

Critics question privatizing/selling further into a company that runs essential public registries, and whether 'golden share' protections are sufficient over the long term once a private owner controls operations. Concerns about fees, service levels and accountability of a privately controlled registry monopoly.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Saskatchewan residents and businesses who rely on land, personal-property and corporate registries; ISC employees; the prospective private buyer; and taxpayers.

Bill 608 The Rent Control Act, 2025 (private member's bill) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: April ChiefCalf (NDP Housing critic), Saskatchewan NDP · Status: First reading November 24, 2025; did NOT advance - died on the order paper when the session adjourned. The Sask Party government stated it is firmly opposed.

Opposition bill that would cap annual rent increases by tying the maximum increase to the Consumer Price Index (averaged over a 12-month period ending March 31 of the previous year), with a five-year exemption for newly built units to protect new construction. Aimed at stopping large year-over-year rent hikes.

FOR

Responds to Saskatchewan's sharp rent increases (the NDP cites ~24% over two years and 40 consecutive months of increases). Supporters argue it protects seniors, families and low-income tenants from sudden double-digit hikes by out-of-province corporate landlords; the new-build exemption is meant to preserve investment.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. This is housing/tenancy economic regulation with no meaningful privacy or surveillance dimension.

AGAINST

The government and many housing economists argue rent control discourages new rental supply and maintenance, worsening shortages over time. As an opposition private member's bill in a majority legislature, it had no realistic path to passage and was not adopted.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Renters (especially lower-income and fixed-income tenants), landlords (particularly large corporate landlords), and the rental-housing market.

Bill 611 The Constitutional Questions (Notwithstanding Clause Referral) Amendment Act (private member's bill)

RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Nicole Sarauer (NDP House Leader), Saskatchewan NDP · Status: First reading December 4, 2025; did NOT advance - the Sask Party government rejected/declined to advance it, so it died on the order paper.

Opposition bill that would require any future Saskatchewan law invoking the Charter's notwithstanding clause (s.33) to be automatically referred to the Saskatchewan Court of Appeal within 90 days, asking the court whether the law violates Charter s.2 or ss.7-15 and, if so, whether it is 'reasonable and demonstrably justified' under s.1. It would not block use of the clause, but would force a public judicial opinion on the rights impact.

FOR

A pro-accountability, rights-protective measure: it would create transparency and an independent judicial check whenever a government overrides Charter rights, without removing the legislature's power. Framed against Alberta's use of the notwithstanding clause to override teachers' rights, and supported by labour (CUPE Saskatchewan).

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Positive for civil liberties in design: it is specifically aimed at protecting Charter rights (fundamental freedoms, legal rights, equality) by ensuring judicial scrutiny whenever a government preemptively overrides them. No privacy downside; it is a democratic-accountability and rights-protection mechanism.

AGAINST

Government argues the notwithstanding clause is a legitimate tool and that mandatory referrals would add cost, delay and judicial entanglement to validly enacted laws. Opponents of the clause itself argue a non-binding court opinion is a weak safeguard. As an opposition bill, it had no path to passage.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Saskatchewan residents whose Charter rights could be affected by future use of the notwithstanding clause; workers/unions; the courts and the legislature.

Bill 628 The Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Amendment Act (private member's bill) RIGHTS-

POSITIVE

Sponsor: Meara Conway (NDP Justice critic), Saskatchewan NDP · Status: First reading May 13, 2026 (the day before adjournment); did NOT advance - died on the order paper. One of a cluster of accountability/transparency PMBs Conway tabled the same day (alongside lobbyist-transparency and conflict-of-interest bills).

Opposition bill to amend Saskatchewan's access-to-information and privacy law (FOIP). Full text was not yet debated, but it is part of an NDP transparency/accountability package aimed at strengthening the public's right to government information and personal-privacy protections under FOIP.

FOR

Aligns with long-standing calls (including from information and privacy commissioners nationally) to modernize and strengthen access-to-information and privacy regimes, improving government transparency and individuals' control over their personal data.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Directly privacy- and transparency-relevant and rights-positive in intent: it targets the province's core access-to-information and personal-privacy statute. Because the detailed text was not debated, the exact safeguards it would add are UNVERIFIED, but the orientation is toward stronger transparency and privacy protection.

AGAINST

Introduced on the final sitting day with no opportunity for debate or scrutiny, so its specific provisions and trade-offs are not on the public record; as an opposition private member's bill it had no realistic path to passage this session.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Anyone seeking government records (journalists, researchers, citizens), individuals whose personal information government holds, and public bodies subject to FOIP.

Legislative Assembly of New Brunswick

Session: 61st Legislature, 2nd Session (opened October 2025; spring sitting ran into 2026 and wrapped up June 12, 2026). Styled "4 Charles III, 2025-2026." The session is not prorogued, so a fall 2026 sitting can resume under the same session.

Government: Liberal majority. Premier Susan Holt (New Brunswick Liberal Association) — the province's first woman premier, in office since November 2, 2024. Seat standings in the 49-seat House: Liberal 31 (government), Progressive Conservative 16 (Official Opposition), Green 2. Speaker: Francine Landry (Liberal).

VERIFICATION: Legislature/session, government and seat counts confirmed via legnb.ca and Wikipedia; Liberal MAJORITY (31 of 49 seats) under Premier Susan Holt — confirmed, not a minority. Bill numbers, sponsors and statuses were checked against the official legnb.ca bill list for the 61st Legislature, 2nd Session as of June 17, 2026; the spring sitting concluded June 12, 2026, so nearly all listed government bills had received Royal Assent. CIVIL-LIBERTIES PICTURE: This session was dominated by cost-of-living (property tax reform, energy consumer advocate), labour/equity (pay transparency, illness leave), health governance (Public Health Act, patient safety) and Indigenous self-governance (First Nations bylaw enforcement) — most of it rights-positive or relief-oriented. No major new surveillance/policing or sweeping criminal-justice bill was identified for this session (several justice bills, e.g., Bills 27-35, were technical court-administration updates by AG McKee and were excluded as non-consequential to civil liberties). The clearest discrete privacy concern is Bill 42 (new pathway to disclose sensitive child/family information to professional regulatory bodies). Bill 44 (lobbying) is deliberately transparency-by-disclosure (rights-positive) but publishes lobbyist/official details and could chill some grassroots advocacy. NOTABLE NON-PASSED / EXCLUDED ITEMS: Bill 23 (An Act Respecting the Right to a Healthy Environment), a Green Party PMB by David Coon, was DEFEATED at second reading — worth flagging as a rejected rights-expanding measure. Bill 1 ('An Act to Perpetuate a Certain Ancient Right') is a purely ceremonial pro-forma bill introduced at the start of every session to assert the Assembly's independence from the Crown; it is never enacted and is not substantive. Bill 11 (Statistics Act) is administrative only (moves the appointment of the Statistics Agency director from cabinet to the minister) with NO data-privacy implications, so it was excluded as trivial, as were commemorative/technical items (e.g., Mactaquac Life Achievement Project Act). CAVEATS: A few news articles captured bills at first reading; where the authoritative legnb.ca list now shows Royal Assent (e.g., Bills 40 and 49), the official status was used. Some private-Act bills (e.g., Bill 51, New Brunswick Real Estate Association Act) are narrow industry/professional matters and were excluded. The 2nd session is not prorogued, so statuses could evolve if the House resumes in fall 2026. SOURCES: legnb.ca official bill list and bill texts; gnb.ca news releases (First Nations bylaws, pay transparency, sick leave, health quality, property tax reform); CBC News, Global News, CTV News (energy advocate, property tax, employment standards, public health officer); Fasken and McInnes Cooper legal analyses (lobbying law, illness leave); East Coast Environmental Law (Bill 45); Union of Municipalities of N.B. (property tax); Wikipedia (61st N.B. Legislature, seat standings).

Bill 49 An Act Respecting Property Tax Reform RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Aaron Kennedy (Minister of Finance / Local Government file; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed during the spring 2026 sitting; introduced May 27, 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

The Holt government's signature cost-of-living measure. It overhauls how property taxes are calculated: it separates rising assessments from how much municipalities collect (a 'rate stabilizer' that automatically pushes rates down when values rise), adds 'spike protection' capping a homeowner's annual tax increase at 10% (the cap disappears when the home is sold), extends the assessment-appeal window from 21 to 30 days, enhances the Property Tax Allowance for lower-income owners, and requires bills to show whether a municipality is charging above the province's suggested rate. It follows a one-year (2026) assessment freeze.

FOR

Aims to end the practice of municipalities reaping 'windfall' revenue from soaring assessments; gives homeowners more predictable bills and protection from sudden spikes; more transparency on municipal spending; longer appeal period; targeted relief for low-income owners through the allowance program.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Concerns property-assessment data and municipal finance, not personal data beyond the assessment roll that is already public.

AGAINST

The Union of Municipalities of N.B. calls it 'a funding cut disguised as an affordability measure,' estimating up to \$58M in lost municipal revenue and warning it forces municipalities to raise rates or cut services and worsens regional inequality (communities with little new construction lose most). Critics note spike protection 'gives the biggest break to those who need it least' and does little for renters or low-income families; the freeze does not actually lower most tax bills.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All N.B. residential and commercial property owners; municipalities/local governments; renters indirectly (limited direct benefit); the provincial assessment system (Service New Brunswick).

Bill 45 Mineral Resources Act (new Act replacing the 1985 Mining Act) WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. John Herron (Minister of Natural Resources / Environment; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

A full rewrite of New Brunswick's mining law to fast-track 'critical minerals' projects (e.g., the Lake George antimony deposit) and align with the federal critical-minerals push. It streamlines permitting and approvals, modernizes claim staking and royalties, and sets out engagement requirements with communities and First Nations. It carries forward provisions on access to land for exploration and the government's ability to expropriate surface rights for mining where agreement with a landowner cannot be reached.

FOR

Replaces a 40-year-old statute; supporters (industry, government) say it cuts red tape, attracts investment and jobs, secures minerals needed for the energy transition and defence, and builds in stronger Indigenous and community engagement than the old Act.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low/Minimal. Main rights issue is property rights (entry onto and potential expropriation of private land), not personal-data privacy.

AGAINST

East Coast Environmental Law and conservation groups pushed for amendments to strengthen environmental safeguards, transparency, public consultation and the duty to consult Indigenous nations, arguing 'streamlining' risks weakening oversight. Farmers and rural landowners have long objected to prospectors entering private/agricultural land and to expropriation powers that favour mining companies over owners.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Private and agricultural landowners; First Nations whose territory overlaps mineral claims; mining/exploration companies and investors; rural communities; environmental and watershed advocates.

Bill 50 An Act Respecting the Enforcement of First Nations Laws and the Prosecution of Offences under First Nations Laws RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Robert McKee, K.C. (Attorney General / Minister of Justice; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026; introduced May 27, 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

Amends the Provincial Offences Procedure Act so that provincial enforcement and prosecution procedures can be applied to First Nations bylaws when a First Nation chooses to opt in. It lets police and designated First Nations enforcement officers issue tickets/appearance notices for bylaw violations, allows more serious matters to proceed as formal court charges, and returns collected fines to the First Nation. Developed with the Wolastoqey Nation, Mi'gmawe'l Tplu'taqnn Inc., Elsipogtog and Sitansisk (St. Mary's).

FOR

Fixes a long-standing gap where First Nations bylaws (on public safety, land use, environment, community well-being) went unenforced and unprosecuted; advances Indigenous self-governance and a government-to-government relationship; opt-in/voluntary; backed by First Nations chiefs (Allan Polchies, George Ginnish) and police services.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Standard provincial-offences enforcement (tickets, court process); no new surveillance or data-collection powers.

AGAINST

Few public objections. Watch-points raised generally about such regimes: ensuring the opt-in is genuinely community-led, adequate funding for First Nations enforcement capacity, and consistent due-process protections for those charged under bylaws.

WHO IT AFFECTS

First Nations communities and governments in New Brunswick; residents and visitors on-reserve subject to bylaws; police and First Nations enforcement officers; provincial courts.

Bill 44 An Act to Amend the Lobbyists' Registration Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Robert McKee, K.C. (Attorney General; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

A major expansion of lobbying-transparency rules. It widens who must register as a lobbyist (the Integrity Commissioner estimated nearly 2,000 more registrants), requires monthly public reporting of essentially every lobbying communication — naming the official lobbied, and the date, location and subject of the contact — and gives the Integrity Commissioner new investigation powers and the ability to impose administrative monetary penalties directly. Law firm Fasken called it potentially 'Canada's most onerous lobbying disclosure law.'

FOR

Sharply increases transparency about who is influencing government and on what; strengthens enforcement with real penalties; brings N.B. from one of the weakest regimes to among the strongest. Pro-accountability and democratic-integrity advocates broadly welcome more sunlight on lobbying.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low and intentional. By design it publishes the identities and meeting details of paid lobbyists and the public officials they contact — a transparency trade-off. Not aimed at ordinary citizens, though grassroots/volunteer advocates could be swept in, raising some chilling-effect concern for civic participation.

AGAINST

Industry/legal critics call the monthly, communication-by-communication reporting burdensome and a compliance trap, especially for small organizations, charities and volunteers who lobby. Transparency advocates note it still leaves loopholes: unpaid lobbying, lobbying invited by the official, lobbying about enforcement of a law, and lobbying of political-party officials remain largely outside the regime.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Paid and in-house lobbyists, consultants, corporations, industry associations, NGOs and charities that lobby; public office holders; the Integrity Commissioner; the public (as beneficiaries of disclosure).

Bill 42 An Act Respecting the Disclosure of Information to Professional Regulatory Bodies WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Cindy Miles (Minister responsible for the Child/Family services file; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026; introduced May 12, 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

Amends the Child and Youth Well-Being Act and the Family Services Act to authorize disclosure of information held under those Acts to a professional regulatory body (one authorized under a private Act, e.g., a licensing college) that is investigating the conduct of one of its members in delivering professional services. In effect, it lets child-welfare and family-services information be shared with bodies like nursing, social-work, medical or teaching colleges conducting disciplinary investigations.

FOR

Closes an information gap so that regulators can properly investigate professionals (social workers, nurses, doctors, etc.) implicated in child-welfare or family-services matters, improving accountability and child/patient safety; can help remove unfit practitioners.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium concern. It creates a new pathway for highly sensitive personal information about children and families to flow to outside professional bodies during investigations. Whether this is proportionate depends on safeguards (necessity, minimization, confidentiality) that are not fully detailed in the bill and may rely on existing statutes or regulations.

AGAINST

The bill text adds the disclosure gateway without spelling out, in the amendment itself, which categories of sensitive information may be shared, notice to affected families/children, consent exceptions, or limits on the regulator's downstream use. Privacy advocates would want explicit minimization and use-restriction safeguards given how sensitive child-protection and family files are.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Children and families with files under child-welfare/family-services law; professionals (social workers, health-care and education professionals) under investigation; professional regulatory colleges; the Department responsible for child and youth well-being.

Bills 46 & 47 Energy Sector Consumer Advocate Act + An Act Respecting the Energy Sector Consumer Advocate (with related An Act to Amend the Electricity Act) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. René Legacy (Deputy Premier / Minister of Finance and Treasury Board / Energy file; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026; tabled late May 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

Creates a new Energy Sector Consumer Advocate to represent residential customers and small businesses before the Energy and Utilities Board (EUB). The advocate can investigate complaints from individual NB Power customers and refer unresolved issues to the EUB. It replaces the existing 'public intervener' role. This follows an independent review of NB Power (the public utility's rising rates, aging infrastructure and roughly \$6-billion debt).

FOR

Gives ordinary ratepayers and small businesses a dedicated champion at the regulator and a complaints-handling avenue against a monopoly utility; a former intervener called the bill 'quite progressive'; responds directly to public anger over electricity rate hikes; part of a broader NB Power accountability push.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Handles customer billing/service complaints; no new surveillance or data powers beyond what is needed to investigate complaints.

AGAINST

Replacing the 'public intervener' (who represented the broad public interest in rate cases) with a complaints/consumer-focused advocate could narrow who speaks for the overall public interest in big rate decisions. Critics/Global News noted the government did not fully commit to non-interference / arms-length independence for the utility, leaving questions about political influence.

WHO IT AFFECTS

NB Power residential customers and small businesses; the EUB; NB Power; the former public intervener; all electricity ratepayers.

Bill 24 Pay Transparency Act RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Lyne Chantal Boudreau (Minister responsible for Women's Equality / Labour file; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (received Royal Assent June 12, 2026; introduced March 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

Requires employers to include salary ranges in publicly advertised and internal job postings, bans the use of salary history in hiring decisions, protects employees from reprisal for discussing their pay, and requires employers to disclose pay gaps to the government. Framed as a first step toward phasing in pay equity in the private sector.

FOR

Helps close gender and other pay gaps by making pay more visible; protects workers who talk about wages; reduces information asymmetry favouring employers; brings N.B. in line with provinces like B.C. and Ontario. Supported by equity and labour advocates.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low/positive. It pushes pay information into the open (job-posting ranges; aggregate pay-gap reporting to government). Pay-gap data filed with government is generally aggregate; individual privacy risk is limited and the worker-protection provisions are rights-positive.

AGAINST

Some employers/retail-sector groups cite added administrative and compliance burden. Advocates note it stops short of full proactive pay equity for the private sector (it is a 'first step'), and effectiveness depends on enforcement and the scope of reporting set in regulation.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All N.B. employers and job applicants/employees; women and equity-seeking workers especially; the labour ministry/enforcement.

Bill 26 An Act to Amend the Employment Standards Act (long-term illness and injury leave) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Jean-Claude D'Amours (Minister of Post-Secondary Education, Training and Labour; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026; introduced March 2026). Verified on legnb.ca.

Creates a new job-protected leave of up to 27 weeks of UNPAID leave in any 52-week period for an employee's own serious illness or injury, available to employees with more than 90 continuous days of service, with a duty to notify the employer promptly. It is a large increase from the previous five-day allowance and harmonizes N.B. with most other provinces and federal EI sickness-benefit timelines.

FOR

Protects seriously ill or injured workers from losing their jobs while they recover; aligns N.B. with the rest of Canada and with EI sickness benefits; a law professor said it brings N.B. 'in line with the rest of Canada.' Strongly supported by labour and health advocates.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Employers may request reasonable medical documentation; standard employment-standards handling of health information applies.

AGAINST

The leave is UNPAID, so lower-income workers may not be able to afford to take it; advocates wanted paid sick days (business groups pushed back on paid leave in a 2023 consultation). Employers, especially small businesses, cite staffing and cost-of-coverage concerns over a 27-week absence.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Employees who suffer serious illness/injury; employers (especially small businesses managing coverage); the broader N.B. labour force.

Bill 2 An Act to Amend the Public Health Act (Chief Medical Officer of Health) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Dr. John Dornan (Minister of Health; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed in the 2nd session). Verified on legnb.ca.

Changes how New Brunswick's Chief Medical Officer of Health is appointed and overseen. Cabinet (not just the Health Minister) appoints the officer from a list of candidates and can dismiss only for cause; any government directive to the officer must be in writing, and the officer may make such directives public in the Royal Gazette; and the officer must file annual public reports on notifiable diseases, outbreaks, public-health emergencies, inspections and vaccinations.

FOR

Aims to insulate public-health advice from political interference and increase transparency (written, publishable directives; mandatory annual reporting) — a direct response to pandemic-era controversies over the independence of the top doctor. Dornan framed it as keeping health decisions 'rooted in science, not politics.'

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low/positive. Reporting is on aggregate public-health statistics, not identifiable individuals; the transparency provisions are rights-positive (more public information about public-health decision-making).

AGAINST

Mixed reaction: some argued giving cabinet (rather than an independent process) the appointment and for-cause removal power could still leave the officer politically exposed, and that true independence requires an arms-length appointment. Debate over whether the safeguards go far enough.

WHO IT AFFECTS

The Chief Medical Officer of Health and public-health system; the general public (transparency and trust in health emergencies); future pandemic/outbreak governance.

Bill 40 An Act Respecting Health Quality and Patient Safety LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Dr. John Dornan (Minister of Health; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (passed spring 2026; introduced May 5, 2026 — official legnb.ca list shows Royal Assent, superseding earlier first-reading news reports).

Updates the framework for reviewing and learning from patient-safety incidents in the health system. It clarifies what counts as a 'safety incident,' improves how incidents are reviewed and shared 'to support system-wide learning,' strengthens collaboration and consistency among health organizations, establishes an advisory committee, and improves the use of data to track safety trends, with stated aims of more transparency for patients and families.

FOR

Should improve patient safety and quality of care through better incident review, data-driven trend analysis and system-wide learning; more transparency for affected patients and families. Generally welcomed in the health sector.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low. Involves health-incident data; such systems usually de-identify and protect data, and quality-improvement information is often legally privileged. Patient-confidentiality handling is the main consideration rather than expanded surveillance.

AGAINST

The PC opposition dismissed parts of the Liberals' spring legislative package as 'housekeeping.' Patient-safety review regimes typically include confidentiality/privilege protections so clinicians report candidly — the trade-off is that some incident details may be shielded from disclosure (e.g., in litigation), which patient advocates can find frustrating.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Patients and families; hospitals, health authorities and clinicians; the health-quality oversight system.

Bill 21 An Act to Amend the Child and Youth Well-Being Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Cindy Miles (Minister responsible for child and family services; Liberal) · Status: Royal Assent / law (introduced November 21, 2025; passed in the 2nd session). Verified on legnb.ca.

A targeted amendment to the 2022 Child and Youth Well-Being Act (the province's child-welfare statute), addressing subsection 47(3). It is a focused fix within the child-protection framework rather than a broad overhaul; full details of the specific provision were not elaborated in public coverage.

FOR

Refines and strengthens the relatively new child-welfare regime to better protect vulnerable children and close gaps identified since the Act took effect.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low/Medium. Child-welfare files are highly sensitive; any change touching information-handling for children/families warrants minimization and confidentiality safeguards. (Note the separate, more clearly privacy-relevant disclosure gateway is in Bill 42.)

AGAINST

Limited public analysis available; as a narrow technical amendment its real-world effect depends on the specific provision and implementation. Child-welfare advocates generally watch for adequate resourcing behind any statutory change.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Children and youth in or at risk of entering the child-welfare system; their families; social workers and the Department responsible for child and youth well-being.

Prince Edward Island PE

Legislative Assembly of Prince Edward Island

Session: 67th General Assembly, 3rd Session. The 2nd Session was prorogued Feb 20, 2026; the 3rd Session opened Tuesday, March 24, 2026. The spring sitting ran about eight weeks and wrapped up in late May 2026 with royal assent in the George Coles Building (Province House remains closed for renovations). Under the parliamentary calendar the fall sitting begins the first Tuesday of November 2026.

Government: Progressive Conservative (PC) majority government. Premier Rob Lantz, sworn in February 9, 2026, after Dennis King resigned as premier/PC leader (Bloyce Thompson served briefly as interim premier in late 2025/early 2026). The PCs hold a clear working majority of the 27-seat House (roughly 19-21 PC seats depending on vacancies), with the Liberals as Official Opposition (about 4 seats) and the Greens (about 2-3 seats, now led by Matt MacFarlane). There are current vacancies (e.g., Dennis King's former Brackley-Hunter River seat and Natalie Jameson's Charlottetown-Hillsborough Park seat) pending byelections, and former minister Gilles Arsenault now sits as an Independent after being removed from cabinet and the PC caucus.

CONTEXT AND CAVEATS: (1) The current sitting is the 3rd Session of the 67th General Assembly. The spring 2026 sitting (March 24 to ~late May) was unusually turbulent: a new premier (Rob Lantz) just weeks into the job, a record deficit budget, the withdrawn Conflict of Interest bill (Bill 102), and an RCMP investigation into former cabinet minister Gilles Arsenault over a \$100,000 developer donation tied to a wetland permit (he was removed from cabinet/caucus and now sits as an Independent; he sought a leave of absence after missing most of the sitting). (2) VERIFICATION LIMITS: assembly.pe.ca uses bot protection that blocked automated access to its live status-of-bills index, and CBC blocked direct fetches; lassembly.pe.ca, the 2026 Parliamentary Calendar, and corroborating news (CBC PEI, The Canadian Press wire mirrors, PEI Green caucus). Where a bill's final passage could not be independently confirmed, the status field says so - re-check assembly.pe.ca for current stages, as bills move fast and a fall sitting begins in November 2026. (3) SCOPE NOTE: PEI is a small legislature; few bills touch surveillance/policing or digital regulation directly. The clearest privacy/civil-liberties items are the 2025 Lands Protection Act 'public investigations' amendment (privacy-commissioner concerns about disclosing sensitive personal data) and, on government-accountability grounds, the dropped Conflict of Interest bill. Two recent but prior-session laws (Bill 15 trade/mobility; the Lands Protection transparency amendment) are included because they are consequential and very recent. (4) I deliberately EXCLUDED an unverified claim circulating in some search summaries about a spring-2026 'Education Act amendment' high point - it appeared alongside clearly erroneous details (wrong party leader names, references to a prior premier's budget) and could not be confirmed, so it is not listed. (5) Seat totals shifted repeatedly during this Assembly due to resignations (Dennis King), an interim premier (Bloyce Thompson), Arsenault's move to Independent, and pending byelections; the PC majority is not in doubt, but exact current seat counts should be reverified.

Operating Budget 2026-27 (Appropriation Act / budget measures) 2026-27 Operating Budget and tax/affordability measures WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Jill Burridge, Minister of Finance and Affordability (PC) · Status: Tabled April 14, 2026; passed and given royal assent in the spring sitting (late May 2026). Both opposition parties voted against it.

A record planned deficit of about \$410M (revenues ~\$3.4B, spending ~\$3.8B). Scraps the P.E.I. Energy Rebate Program (a 10% subsidy on the first 2,000 kWh, worth ~\$175/yr) after June 2026, redirecting the money into a new income-tested 'P.E.I. Essentials Benefit' (~\$310/yr for individuals, ~\$365 for couples, full benefit up to \$95,000 income, phasing out by \$114,000). Adds a new top personal income tax bracket on income over \$200,000 and raises the non-resident property tax rate by 20 cents per \$100 of assessed value. Maintains \$10/day childcare and adds health spending (long-term care beds, in-home senior support, the UPEI medical school, recruitment).

FOR

Government frames it as responsible 'tough choices' amid a structural deficit; the Essentials Benefit is more targeted to low/middle-income households than a flat electricity rebate; new high-earner bracket and non-resident property tax shift some burden to wealthier and out-of-province owners; protects childcare and adds health-care money.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. The Essentials Benefit is income-tested through the tax system, so eligibility relies on existing CRA/provincial income data; no new surveillance powers.

AGAINST

Critics (Greens, Liberals, NDP, anti-poverty and business groups) call the record deficit unsustainable and the budget thin on detail. Ending the energy rebate means many Islanders' electricity bills rise (the Greens cited a constituent losing ~\$80/month) just as Maritime Electric seeks higher rates; experts say it signals reduced focus on climate/energy-efficiency. Benefit cut-offs leave some squeezed households worse off.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Island households (electricity costs), low- and middle-income families and seniors (new benefit), high earners (over \$200K), and non-resident property owners.

Bill 102 (2026, 3rd Session) An Act to Amend the Conflict of Interest Act (withdrawn 'MacEwen' bill) WATCH

Sponsor: Brendan Curran, PC MLA (government backbench bill, on behalf of the PC caucus) · Status: Introduced spring 2026; passed first reading and advanced, then WITHDRAWN by the sponsor in late April/early May 2026 after the Conflict of Interest Commissioner and others objected. Not law.

Would have narrowed P.E.I.'s Conflict of Interest Act so that a sitting cabinet minister could keep a private business/licence (specifically aimed at letting decades-long lobster fisher and minister Sidney MacEwen retain his fishing licence while in cabinet, after he was forced to choose between cabinet and the licence in April 2026).

FOR

Supporters argued the existing rules are unrealistically strict for a small province where MLAs often come from farming/fishing and that the change would let experienced legislators serve in cabinet without divesting their livelihood.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal as to ordinary citizens' privacy. The civil-liberties concern is about government accountability and integrity (weakening ethics/anti-corruption safeguards), not personal data or surveillance.

AGAINST

P.E.I. Conflict of Interest Commissioner Judy Burke said the amendment was 'so broad that it effectively negates the intent of the Conflict of Interest Act.' New Brunswick's integrity commissioner Charles Murray warned it would permit clear conflicts and 'significantly weaken' the law. Opposition Greens called it a 'scramble' to keep one minister in cabinet. The backlash led the government to drop it.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Cabinet ministers and MLAs with private business interests; broadly, public trust in government ethics and accountability on P.E.I.

Lands Protection Act amendment (2026, 3rd Session) Amendments to the Lands Protection Act (non-resident municipal land purchases) LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government (Minister of Land and Environment / Justice; part of the spring 2026 'actions on land' package) · Status: Part of the government's spring 2026 land agenda. Status should be verified on assembly.pe.ca — reported as introduced/advancing in the spring sitting; treat as in progress rather than confirmed law.

Would require non-Islanders (non-residents) buying even small parcels (one acre or less) inside municipalities to first get provincial cabinet approval. Currently cabinet approval is triggered only above five acres or 165 feet of shoreline. Aimed at more transparency and oversight of who owns land on the 1.4-million-acre Island.

FOR

Responds to long-standing Island concern about land concentration and out-of-province/corporate ownership; tightens a perceived loophole; gives government more visibility into small-parcel purchases by non-residents.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low. It increases government collection/review of land-ownership and buyer information for non-residents, but land registration is already a public/regulated process; main concern is administrative reach, not surveillance.

AGAINST

The Federation of P.E.I. Municipalities questioned whether cabinet can realistically vet every small municipal land purchase, warning of bureaucratic bottlenecks and delays in local real-estate transactions; critics say it adds red tape.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Non-resident (off-Island) property buyers, municipalities, realtors and the Island land market.

Bill 25 (2026, 3rd Session) Government Reorganization Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Bloyce Thompson, Minister of Justice and Public Safety and Attorney General (PC) · Status: Introduced/first reading April 17, 2026; a government bill that proceeded through the spring sitting. Verify final passage on assembly.pe.ca.

A machinery-of-government bill that repeals/replaces the structure under the Public Departments Act to reflect Premier Lantz's spring 2026 reorganization: it renames and reshuffles departments and ministerial responsibilities. Notably it establishes a 'Department of Economic Development, Trade and Artificial Intelligence,' a 'Department of Finance and Affordability,' 'Health and Wellness,' 'Housing and Communities,' 'Land and Environment,' and 'Social Development and Seniors,' and makes consequential amendments across many statutes.

FOR

Largely technical/administrative; aligns statutes with the new cabinet structure and signals priority areas (e.g., explicitly naming AI within economic development). Provides legal clarity for departmental authority.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal directly. Worth watching: it formally creates an AI-focused economic development mandate, but the bill itself sets no AI governance, data-protection, or surveillance rules.

AGAINST

Mostly non-controversial 'housekeeping,' but consequential renaming bills can obscure shifts in responsibility and accountability; folding 'artificial intelligence' into a department name without a dedicated AI/data-governance framework drew little scrutiny.

WHO IT AFFECTS

The provincial public service, ministers, and anyone interacting with renamed/reorganized departments.

Financial Administration Act amendment (special warrants) - 2026, 3rd Session An Act to Amend the Financial Administration Act (special warrants) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Matt MacFarlane, Leader of the Green Party / Official Opposition Green caucus (private member's bill) · Status: Tabled spring 2026 and PASSED in April 2026 - a notable example of an opposition private member's bill becoming law. Confirm royal-assent date on assembly.pe.ca.

Tightens the rules for 'special warrants' - cabinet's power to authorize spending when the legislature is not sitting. It adds a requirement that a special-warrant payment first be deemed 'urgently and immediately required,' curbing the government's ability to spend outside the normal legislative budget process.

FOR

Strengthens legislative control of public money and fiscal accountability after the Auditor General and opposition flagged heavy reliance on special warrants; a rare cross-party win that constrains executive spending discretion.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. This is a fiscal-accountability/separation-of-powers measure; no personal-data or surveillance dimension.

AGAINST

Limited criticism; government may argue genuine emergencies still need flexibility. Effectiveness depends on how strictly 'urgently and immediately required' is interpreted and enforced.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Taxpayers and the legislature (improved oversight of government spending); the cabinet/Treasury Board (reduced unilateral spending power).

Electric Power Act amendment (2026, 3rd Session) - defeated An Act to Amend the Electric Power Act (utility accountability / lower electricity rates) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Peter Bevan-Baker, Green MLA and Green energy critic (private member's bill) · Status: Tabled April 2026; VOTED DOWN by the PC majority in the spring 2026 sitting. Not law.

Would have created a performance-based regulatory framework for Maritime Electric: mandatory industry-standard reliability targets and benchmarks for outages, and a requirement that cheaper alternatives be considered before the utility makes major (rate-driving) investments. Pitched as making the energy system 'accountable, reliable and affordable.'

FOR

Aimed squarely at affordability and reliability after storm-related outages and rate pressure; would have given the regulator clearer tools to hold the private utility to service standards and scrutinize costs passed to ratepayers.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Consumer-protection/utility-regulation measure; no personal-data or surveillance implications.

AGAINST

Defeated by government, which argued issues are better handled through the regulator (IRAC) and existing processes; the PCs framed rate pressure as Maritime Electric's responsibility. Critics of the bill said it could complicate the regulatory regime.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All Maritime Electric ratepayers (households and businesses) - especially relevant as IRAC approved higher rates to recover ~\$37M in post-Fiona cleanup costs in June 2026.

Community Care Facilities and Nursing Homes Act amendment (2026, 3rd Session) An Act to Amend the Community Care Facilities and Nursing Homes Act (long-term care rate caps) RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Matt MacFarlane, Green Party leader (private member's bill) · Status: Tabled in the spring 2026 sitting. Status uncertain - verify on assembly.pe.ca; reported as introduced, with no confirmation it passed (government bills and budget dominated the agenda).

Would require the government to set maximum daily accommodation rates for long-term care/nursing homes annually, beginning July 1, 2026, to make rates fair and predictable. Prompted by reports of seniors facing increases of at least 24% in a year (about \$1,000/month) and roughly 38% over two years, with no rate protection comparable to the Residential Tenancy Act that protects ordinary renters.

FOR

Would protect vulnerable seniors and families from steep, unpredictable long-term-care cost increases and bring P.E.I. in line with other provinces that cap such rates; widely seen as a needed affordability/seniors-protection measure.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. A consumer/seniors price-protection measure; no privacy or surveillance dimension.

AGAINST

Government has been cool to opposition rate-control bills; operators may argue caps strain facility finances and could affect capacity/quality if not paired with funding. As a private member's bill from a small caucus, passage is uncertain.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Seniors in long-term care and their families; nursing-home and community-care operators.

Lands Protection Act amendment - public land investigations (2025, 2nd Session - recent and precedent-setting) An Act to Amend the Lands Protection Act (making IRAC land investigations public) WATCH

Sponsor: Matt MacFarlane, Green Party (private member's bill) · Status: Passed UNANIMOUSLY in November 2025 (prior, 2nd Session). Now law - included here because it is recent, consequential, and the clearest privacy/civil-liberties case in the current Assembly.

Makes all documents and reports related to Island Regulatory and Appeals Commission (IRAC) investigations into Lands Protection Act compliance public, including investigations currently underway. Driven by transparency demands around large land holdings (e.g., the Great Enlightenment Buddhist Institute Society, GEBIS, which supported the change).

FOR

Major win for transparency and public oversight of who controls Island land and how land limits are enforced; backed across party lines and even by a group under investigation.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

This is the standout privacy/civil-liberties item: it mandates broad public disclosure of investigation records that may include highly sensitive personal information (financial data, religious/political beliefs, informant identities). The privacy commissioner publicly flagged the lack of safeguards/redaction balancing.

AGAINST

P.E.I. Information and Privacy Commissioner Denise Doiron warned the right to know must be balanced against privacy - investigation files can contain bank account numbers, a person's political or religious beliefs, or the identity of confidential informants, and blanket disclosure could expose sensitive personal data and chill informants.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Large landholders and corporations under IRAC scrutiny, confidential informants, and the public/journalists seeking land-ownership transparency.

Bill 15 (2025, 2nd Session - foundational, now in force) Interprovincial Trade and Mobility Act LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Premier Rob Lantz (PC) (government bill) · Status: Introduced April 11, 2025; passed and given royal assent in May 2025 (prior, 2nd Session). Now law - included because it is recent, structurally significant, and tied to the federal free-trade push that took effect Jan 1, 2026.

Mirrors Nova Scotia's law and dovetails with the federal Free Trade and Labour Mobility in Canada Act. P.E.I. agrees to accept the inspections, standards and professional credentials of 'reciprocating' provinces: goods meeting another province's standards are accepted, and regulated professionals/tradespeople from reciprocating jurisdictions get expedited licensing (with regulators expected to decide within 10 business days).

FOR

Reduces interprovincial trade and labour-mobility barriers, helps address worker shortages (e.g., health, trades) and lowers costs; business groups (CFIB) praised it; part of a national 'one Canadian economy' effort.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Concerns are about professional-standards and consumer/public-safety oversight rather than personal data or surveillance.

AGAINST

Opposition parties and several professional bodies (psychologists, teachers, engineers, social workers, CPAs, land surveyors) warned the government moved too fast and sought exemptions, citing risks to professional/public-safety standards and local oversight if out-of-province credentials are recognized too automatically. Even some within government reportedly cautioned about the pace.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Regulated professionals and tradespeople, professional licensing bodies, businesses moving goods across provincial lines, and consumers/patients relying on those services.

Newfoundland and Labrador NL

House of Assembly of Newfoundland and Labrador

Session: 51st General Assembly, 1st Session. Spring sitting ran Feb 23 – June 2, 2026; now adjourned to the call of the Chair. Fall sitting scheduled to begin October 26, 2026.

Government: Progressive Conservative MAJORITY government. Premier Tony Wakeham (sworn in Oct 29, 2025 after the Oct 14, 2025 general election).

Seats: PC 21, Liberal 15, NDP 2, Independent 2 (of 40). The PC win ended a decade of Liberal government and was widely described as an upset.

Context: This is the first sitting of a new PC majority government under Premier Tony Wakeham, elected Oct 14, 2025 in an upset that ended a decade of Liberal rule. The throne speech (Mar 2, 2026) and Budget 2026 ('Opportunity for All of Us,' tabled late April) framed three priorities — lower taxes/cost of living, better health care, and safer communities — against a large projected deficit (~\$689M) and a bet on oil, hydroelectricity and critical-minerals revenue. The spring sitting passed 21 bills (the most since 2018) and CBC described it as a 'tense' sitting; opposition (Liberal Leader John Hogan, NDP Leader Jim Dinn) characterized the early PC record as cuts, delays and excuses. Civil-liberties/privacy read: Most of this session's legislation is affordability, fiscal or service-oriented rather than surveillance- or policing-focused, so dedicated privacy/digital-regulation or police-surveillance bills are largely ABSENT this session. The clearest civil-liberties item is Bill 7 (Endangered Species), whose telewarrant and expanded seizure powers (including electronic devices) drew property-rights and privacy flags — though searches remain judicially authorized. The two new advocate offices (Bills 1 and 2) are rights-positive but carry compel-records powers; the Seniors' Advocate's ability to access an incapacitated or deceased senior's information without consent is the notable nuance. Bill 9 (Future Fund) is best read as a democratic-accountability/fiscal-stewardship controversy rather than a personal-privacy issue. Caveats: Sponsor/ministry attributions are taken from government news releases and reputable news; a few (Bills 2, 10, 19) are confirmed as government bills but I could not independently verify the exact named minister beyond the responsible department, so those are given by portfolio. All statuses (Royal Assent) weren't. Progress of Bills list for the 51st GA, 1st Session as of mid-June 2026. The government has signalled further tax/affordability and health/justice measures for the fall sitting (begins Oct 26, 2026), and a separate Accessibility Act regime predates this session.

Bill 16 (& Bill 17) Income Tax Act, 2000 (Amendment) — affordability tax cuts RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Craig Parry, Minister of Finance (PC) · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026); core measures effective Jan 1, 2026

Nearly doubles the basic personal amount (income exempt from provincial tax) from \$7,410 toward \$13,094 for 2026, rising to a \$15,000 base in 2027 with annual indexing thereafter. Doubles the volunteer firefighters' and search-and-rescue volunteer tax credits from \$3,000 to \$6,000 each. Phases the small-business corporate tax rate down from 2.5% to 1% by 2028.

FOR

Government says it puts more than \$300/year back in the pockets of roughly 285,000 tax filers and removes many low-income earners from the provincial tax rolls; broad, permanent, indexed relief rather than one-time rebates. Cost pegged at ~\$45M in 2026 and ~\$91M the following year. Volunteer-service credits support rural fire/SAR recruitment.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Standard tax administration; no new data collection or surveillance.

AGAINST

Arrives alongside a large projected deficit (~\$689M) and a plan to stop contributing to (and draw down) the Future Fund; critics question affordability of permanent cuts amid structural deficits. Flat dollar relief is modest per household and benefits higher earners in absolute terms too. Opposition frames the PC record so far as 'cuts, delays and excuses.'

WHO IT AFFECTS

Essentially all ~285,000 provincial tax filers (especially low- and middle-income earners), volunteer firefighters and SAR volunteers, and small businesses.

Bill 9 Future Fund Act (Amendment) — restructuring the province's savings fund WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Craig Parry, Minister of Finance (PC) · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026); passed third reading early May 2026

Restructures the ~\$550M Future Fund (the province's heritage/savings fund). Makes annual contributions discretionary instead of mandatory and lets the government withdraw money immediately — years ahead of the previous 2033 lock — but only to service public debt, cover unexpected asset-sale liabilities, and fund offshore oil/gas decommissioning. Removes prior withdrawal limits and the fund's regulatory framework.

FOR

Government argues debt servicing is a defensible use of public money and that flexibility is prudent given the deficit; fulfils an election platform commitment. Targets withdrawals at liabilities rather than general spending.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. Fiscal-governance change; no personal-data or surveillance dimension.

AGAINST

Liberals (Leader John Hogan), the NDP and the Fraser Institute warn it effectively ends the fund's purpose — 'looking at how they can spend that money now' rather than the future. Analysts note the fund earned ~7.36% vs. ~3.8% debt-interest cost, so liquidating it to pay down <3% of provincial debt is poor value. Removing mandatory contributions means little or no saving is expected for at least five years. Democratic-accountability concern: stripping statutory guardrails concentrates fiscal discretion in cabinet.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All residents (long-term provincial finances and intergenerational savings); future governments; bondholders.

Bill 7 Endangered Species Act (Amendment) — enforcement, penalties, search powers WATCH

Sponsor: Hon. Pleaman Forsey, Minister of Forestry, Agriculture and Lands (PC) · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026)

Sharply increases penalties (individual first offence \$3,000–\$50,000; corporate up to \$2,000,000; continuing-violation fines up to \$250,000/day) and expands enforcement. Lets conservation officers obtain telewarrants (by phone/electronic means) when appearing before a judge is impractical, broadens seizure authority (vehicles, refrigerators, storage lockers, equipment, electronic devices capable of use in harming listed species), and extends the cabinet's window to act on listing recommendations from 90 to 180 days. Adds a ministerial permit power for limited use (traditional/ceremonial, research, pre-existing legal possession, 'other activities the minister considers appropriate').

FOR

Modernizes a 2001-era statute, brings deterrent penalties in line with other jurisdictions, and gives officers practical tools to act quickly against poaching/trafficking. Permit carve-outs accommodate Indigenous ceremonial use and legitimate research.

AGAINST

Civil-liberties and property-rights advocates warn the expanded search-and-seizure powers and telewarrants 'may raise privacy and property-rights concerns if not tightly controlled.' The catch-all 'other activities the minister considers appropriate' permit power is criticized as overly broad/discretionary. Doubling the listing-response window could delay protection for at-risk species. Steep fines and vehicle seizure could fall hard on small operators and rural/hunting livelihoods.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Medium. Telewarrant search powers, seizure of electronic devices and broad seizure categories expand state entry/search authority over private property; the safeguard is that warrants (including telewarrants) remain judicially authorized.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Hunters, trappers, rural and resource users, landowners, corporations operating in habitat areas, conservation officers, and Indigenous communities (ceremonial-use permits).

Bill 1 Disability Advocate Act — independent Office of the Disability Advocate RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Joedy Wall, Minister of Social Supports and Well-Being (PC); introduced by Govt House Leader Lloyd Parrott · Status: Royal Assent (April 20, 2026); first bill of the session

Creates an independent Office of the Disability Advocate as a statutory officer of the House of Assembly. The advocate (who must have lived/professional disability experience) receives and investigates complaints about disability services, mediates disputes, conducts research, and recommends systemic improvements across departments, health authorities, housing and service providers.

FOR

Long-sought independent oversight for people with disabilities; statutory independence and a requirement that the advocate have disability experience boost credibility. Investigatory teeth (can compel information and records) make recommendations more than advisory.

AGAINST

Advocate cannot act as legal counsel and issues recommendations rather than binding orders, so impact depends on government follow-through and adequate funding. Disability groups will watch the appointment and budget.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low / positive. The advocate can compel records and override most confidentiality laws for investigations, but must obtain the consent of the person with a disability before requesting their personal or health information, solicitor-client privilege and sensitive records (adoption, youth-justice) are protected, staff are bound by confidentiality, and reports must not identify complainants without consent.

WHO IT AFFECTS

People with disabilities, their families and caregivers, and the departments, health authorities, care providers and housing organizations that serve them.

Bill 2 Seniors' Advocate Act, 2026 — strengthened independent Seniors' Advocate RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Government bill (PC); responsible: Department of Children, Seniors and Social Development / Social Supports · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026)

Re-establishes the Seniors' Advocate as an independent officer of the legislature (6-year term, renewable once) with stronger powers: investigate complaints about seniors' services, enter facilities where seniors are placed, summon witnesses and compel records. Cannot review court decisions, active child/adult-protection investigations, or public-servant employment terms.

FOR

Independent, investigatory oversight of long-term care, home care and seniors' services — timely given 200 new long-term-care beds and travel-nurse reforms in Budget 2026. Facility-access power addresses real concerns about conditions in care.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low. Can access a senior's personal/health information with consent; notably may access WITHOUT consent where the senior lacks decision-making capacity and access serves their interests, or where the senior is deceased and access serves 'the public interest.'

Offsetting safeguards: confidentiality oaths, protection of adoption/youth-justice/protection-reporter records, and a bar on identifying seniors in reports without consent. The without-consent access for incapacitated/deceased seniors is the main point to watch.

AGAINST

Recommendation-based (no binding orders); jurisdictional exclusions limit reach; effectiveness hinges on resourcing and the government acting on findings.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Seniors (65+) and under-65s receiving seniors' services, families, and care/housing/health providers.

Bill 12 Children's Law Act and Family Law Act (Amendment) — modernized family law RIGHTS-POSITIVE

Sponsor: Hon. Helen Conway Ottenheimer, Minister of Justice and Public Safety & Attorney General (PC) · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026)

Aligns provincial family law with the federal Divorce Act. Replaces 'custody/access' with 'decision-making responsibility,' 'parenting time' and 'contact'; centres all orders on the best interests of the child; adds a broad family-violence framework (physical, sexual, psychological, financial abuse and exposure to it); creates 60-day relocation-notice rules; and pushes family dispute resolution (mediation, collaborative law).

FOR

Child-centred, trauma-informed modernization; explicit family-violence and Indigenous-heritage considerations; clearer relocation rules and emphasis on out-of-court resolution can reduce conflict and cost. Broadly supported as overdue harmonization.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Low/medium. Parties must provide 'complete, accurate and up-to-date' information, and courts must review records on restraining orders, child protection and criminal matters — creating cross-database information flows about families, though within judicial proceedings and existing court-confidentiality norms.

AGAINST

Broad family-violence definitions and mandatory information duties increase the evidentiary and procedural load on self-represented parents; effectiveness depends on access to affordable mediation and legal aid. Some worry expansive definitions could be weaponized in high-conflict cases.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Separating/divorcing parents, grandparents and other caregivers, children, family-law lawyers and the courts.

Bill 4 Revenue Administration Act (Amendment) — repeal of the sugar-sweetened beverage tax LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Hon. Craig Parry, Minister of Finance (PC) · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026); the tax was administratively removed effective July 1, 2025 and this Act repeals the underlying framework

Formally repeals the 'sugar tax' (the 20-cents-per-litre Sugar-Sweetened Beverage Tax on pop, sweetened juices, slushies and non-diet fountain drinks introduced in 2022) by striking Part IX.2 of the Act, plus technical tax-definition cleanups.

FOR

Removes a regressive, broadly unpopular levy (~\$9M/year) the government argues hit lower-income households hardest; a flagged affordability/cost-of-living win. Government says programs the tax had funded (school food, glucose-monitoring pilot, physical-activity credit) continue from general revenue.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Public-health groups (Heart & Stroke and others) opposed the repeal, arguing such taxes reduce sugary-drink consumption and that 'walking back the pop tax comes at a cost' in foregone revenue and lost health benefit. Adds to revenue pressure during a deficit.

WHO IT AFFECTS

All consumers of sugary drinks (relief), retailers, and provincial revenues/health-promotion programs.

Bill 10 Workplace Health, Safety and Compensation Act, 2022 (Amendment) — injured-worker retirement benefits

LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government bill (PC); Department of Environment and Labour / responsible minister · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026)

Defines 'temporary earnings-loss benefits' and sets how injured workers' age-65 retirement lump sum is calculated: 5% of extended earnings-loss benefits paid (10% if the worker was in an employer-sponsored pension plan at the time of injury), including qualifying temporary benefits and accrued interest.

FOR

Clarifies and codifies a retirement top-up for long-term injured workers, recognizing lost pension accrual; the higher 10% rate for those with employer pensions partly compensates for forgone workplace retirement savings.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal.

AGAINST

Narrow and technical — does not expand presumptive coverage, occupational-illness recognition or general benefit levels that worker advocates have sought; effect limited to those on extended earnings-loss benefits reaching 65.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Injured workers on extended earnings-loss benefits, the Workplace NL board, and employers (calculation depends on pension-plan status).

Bill 19 Pharmaceutical Services Act (Amendment) — controlled-drug dispensing flexibility

LOWER CONCERN

Sponsor: Government bill (PC); Department of Health and Community Services / responsible minister · Status: Royal Assent (June 2, 2026)

Relaxes the tamper-resistant prescription-pad requirement for controlled drugs in specific situations: telephone prescriptions, transfers between pharmacists/dispensing physicians, prescriptions sent directly from prescriber to pharmacy, and therapeutic substitutions — each where federal law authorizes it.

FOR

Removes administrative friction and aligns provincial rules with federal practice, easing patient access (e.g., remote/rural and continuity-of-care situations) without abandoning safeguards.

PRIVACY & CIVIL LIBERTIES

Minimal. No new prescription-monitoring or data-collection mandate is created in this amendment; changes are procedural.

AGAINST

Loosening controlled-drug pad requirements could marginally raise diversion/fraud risk if federal controls are weak; mostly procedural so impact is limited and tied to federal authorization.

WHO IT AFFECTS

Patients on controlled medications, pharmacists and dispensing physicians.



Don't get fooled — & how to act

Myth-check: "Bill C-206" is NOT a surveillance bill — in this Parliament it is the National Strategy on Brain Injuries Act, a harmless health bill. Bill numbers get recycled every Parliament; always confirm the number on the official site before sharing.

Act in 2 minutes: (1) Email your MP/MLA about a specific bill number — polite and specific. (2) Check the bill's real status on the official site (LEGISinfo federally; your legislature provincially). (3) Submit to committee — committees take written public comments on bills under study, the most direct citizen input there is.

How to spot a bad bill: it's an omnibus pushed through quickly; it lowers a warrant standard; it exempts the government from oversight or freedom-of-information; it expands data collection or surveillance; it applies secrecy retroactively; or it skips Indigenous/public consultation.

🌟 Bad Bills · badbills.ca · Sources: Parliament of Canada / LEGISinfo, Department of Justice, Canada.ca, provincial legislatures & privacy commissioners; analysis from the CCLA, Canadian Constitution Foundation, OpenMedia, EFF, Canadian Council for Refugees, Michael Geist and major law firms; reporting from CBC, The Globe and Mail and regional outlets. Updated June 17, 2026.